

Robust Local-Unitary Rigidity of Stabilizer AME States

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Abstract

Let $q = p^e$ and $m \geq 2$. We prove that every product unitary mapping one stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state to another is Clifford on each party, and the same holds when a party relabelling is allowed. The result covers arbitrary additive stabilizers. Here Clifford is meant in the additive prime-field sense: on Weyl labels a local factor acts through $\text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$, with no $\mathbb{F}_q$ -linearity assumption. Thus local-unitary and local-Clifford equivalence coincide for these states. The proof is a support count: stabilizers contained in any $(m+1)$ -party set project bijectively onto the full Weyl-label space at each retained party, so the corresponding reduced operator determines every local Weyl axis. Via the Choi-state correspondence, every transversal conversion between the associated $[[2m-1, 1, m]]_q$ encoders is therefore Clifford on every physical and logical factor. Their transition maps between local Weyl-label spaces form a complete LU invariant, modulo local trace-symplectic frame changes and party relabelling. A half-set systematic form compresses this invariant to m minimum supports and gives a constructive fixed-label recognition algorithm that is polynomial in m for fixed q . In prime dimension, the same data determine an intrinsic endomorphism algebra, whose dimension is at least two for four and six parties.

We also prove robust rigidity for approximate product symmetries. If the state-vector defect ε is below an explicit threshold of order $\min\{p^{-1}, q^{-1/2}, (2m)^{-1/2}\}$, every local factor lies within normalized Hilbert–Schmidt distance 8ε of a Clifford, and the product unitary decomposes into an exact symmetry and a residual whose collective generator norm is at most $\pi\sqrt{q}\varepsilon$. The proof combines three-region cleaning, finite Weyl–Fourier concentration, the quantized overlap of stabilizer states, and a balanced-cut estimate.

Index Terms—Absolutely maximally entangled states, local Clifford group, local-unitary equivalence, quantitative rigidity, quantum MDS codes, stabilizer cleaning, transversal gates, Weyl operators.

1 Introduction

An absolutely maximally entangled state has maximally mixed reductions on every set containing at most half of its parties. Such states are also called perfect tensors and, after one party is designated as an input, give quantum maximum-distance-separable encoders. They therefore sit at the intersection of multipartite entanglement, stabilizer codes, transversal gates, and tensor-network constructions. Operationally, AME states serve as resources for quantum error correction, threshold secret sharing, and multi-user teleportation; a recent survey reviews these applications and the known local-unitary classes [RMBR⁺26].

This paper asks how rigid their local coordinates are. With the party labels fixed, two states are *local-unitary (LU) equivalent* if a tensor product of one-party unitaries maps one state ray to the other. We say *LU up to party relabelling* when a party permutation is also allowed. The analogous relations are *local-Clifford (LC) equivalence* and LC equivalence up to party relabelling, with every one-party factor required to normalize the chosen Weyl, or Pauli, system. The theorem below uses the latter convention; setting the permutation to the identity gives the fixed-label statement. Local-Clifford equivalence is discrete and

can be studied through finite symplectic linear algebra; local-unitary equivalence is a priori continuous and much larger. The two relations do not coincide for general stabilizer states [JCWY10].

The distinction is both structural and operational. LU equivalence asks whether two preparations represent the same multipartite entanglement resource after independent changes of local basis. LC equivalence reduces that question to finite symplectic data and is directly compatible with the stabilizer description used for encoding and fault-tolerant gates. For an AME state viewed as an encoder Choi state, the same question asks whether a transversal conversion can contain a genuinely non-Clifford factor. A quantitative version is needed when the conversion or symmetry is only approximately realized.

Within the stabilizer AME class on at least four parties, maximal entanglement removes that difference.

For $q = p^e$, “Clifford” below always means the normalizer of the additive Weyl system. Its action on one-party labels lies in $\text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$; it need not be an $\mathbb{F}_q$ -linear 2×2 transformation.

Theorem 1.1 (Local-unitary rigidity). Let $q = p^e$, let $m \geq 2$, and let $|\psi\rangle, |\phi\rangle$ be stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ states for the standard additive Weyl system. Suppose that, for a party permutation π , single-qudit unitaries $U_1, \dots, U_{2m}$, and a phase θ ,

$$(U_1 \otimes \dots \otimes U_{2m})\pi|\psi\rangle = e^{i\theta}|\phi\rangle.$$

Then every U_i normalizes the Weyl system. Thus the displayed equivalence is local Clifford.

The theorem converts a continuous equivalence problem into a finite one. It is valid for every prime power, for arbitrary additive stabilizers, and does not assume CSS form, equal stabilizer phases, classical linearity over $\mathbb{F}_q$, or a particular construction of the AME state. The restriction $m \geq 2$ is sharp: a Bell pair has the continuous symmetry $U \otimes \bar{U}$.

The proof uses one elementary support calculation. On any $(m+1)$ -party set, the stabilizer labels supported there form a group of order q^2 . Projection onto the two-dimensional Weyl-label space of any retained party is bijective. Consequently the reduced operator contains every local Weyl axis exactly once in a matched diagonal decomposition. The uniqueness of that decomposition forces each local unitary to permute the Weyl axes and hence to be Clifford. In ordinary language,

$$\text{AME support counting} \implies \text{all local Weyl axes appear} \implies \text{every local factor is Clifford.} \quad (1.1)$$

The operational code consequence follows by treating one party as the logical input of the associated quantum MDS encoder. Throughout, *transversal* means a tensor product of one-site physical operators with the physical coordinates fixed. Such gates limit the direct spread of errors between physical subsystems, which makes them central to fault-tolerant constructions. The Eastin–Knill theorem rules out a universal transversal gate set for an exact finite-dimensional code [EK09]; the natural family-specific question is therefore which transversal gates remain.

Corollary 1.2 (Factorwise transversal rigidity). Let $V_\psi, V_\phi : \mathbb{C}^q \rightarrow (\mathbb{C}^q)^{\otimes(2m-1)}$ be encoders whose normalized Choi states are stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ states. If

$$(U_1 \otimes \dots \otimes U_{2m-1})V_\psi = V_\phi L,$$

then L and every U_i are Clifford. In particular, no code in this family admits a transversal non-Clifford logical unitary.

General cleaning arguments already constrain the *logical* action of a transversal gate [PY15, Lemma 5]. Corollary 1.2 is stronger in a different direction: it identifies every physical one-site factor as Clifford as well as the induced logical gate. This factorwise conclusion is what turns LU equivalence of the Choi states into finite local symplectic data.

Quantitative question

Exact rigidity does not by itself say what happens when a product unitary only approximately preserves the state. For $U = \bigotimes_i U_i$, define its state-vector defect by

$$\varepsilon(U) = \min_{|z|=1} \|U|\psi\rangle - z|\psi\rangle\|.$$

The direct marginal proof is poorly conditioned for this problem: the nonidentity part of one minimum-support marginal has exponentially small Hilbert–Schmidt norm. We instead regard each party in turn as the logical leg of the associated $[[2m-1, 1, m]]_q$ code. Its physical parties can be partitioned into three correctable regions. A leakage-aware cleaning argument tests the induced logical action by nested commutators, and a finite Fourier argument rounds that action to a Clifford.

The exact constants are useful for applications, so we state them once in the introduction. Their scaling and proof mechanism are the main points. Write $G(\psi)$ for the group of product unitaries that preserve the ray of $|\psi\rangle$.

Theorem 1.3 (Quantitative rounding). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer AME(n, q) state with $n = 2m$, $m \geq 2$, and let $U = \bigotimes_i U_i$. Put

$$\begin{aligned} \tau_p &= \min \left\{ \frac{1}{3}, \frac{\sin(\pi/p)}{2\sqrt{2}} \right\}, & d_p &= (2 - 2p^{-1/2})^{1/2}, \\ R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} &= \min \left\{ \frac{\tau_p}{8}, \frac{1}{4\sqrt{2q}}, \frac{1}{8\pi\sqrt{n}}, \frac{d_p}{1 + 4\pi\sqrt{n}} \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (1.2)$$

If $\varepsilon(U) < R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}}$, then, up to phase,

$$U = g \bigotimes_{i=1}^n e^{ih_i}, \quad g \in G(\psi), \quad \left(\sum_i \|h_i\|_F^2 \right)^{1/2} \leq \pi\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U), \quad (1.3)$$

where the h_i are traceless Hermitian with spectral spread $\lambda_{\max}(h_i) - \lambda_{\min}(h_i)$ at most π . Before the exact symmetry g is selected, each U_i is within normalized Hilbert–Schmidt distance $8\varepsilon(U)$ of a one-qudit Clifford. Uniformly over prime powers and existing AME states,

$$R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} = \Theta\left(\min\{p^{-1}, q^{-1/2}, n^{-1/2}\}\right).$$

The proof has three stages. First, quantitative cleaning places every nested logical Weyl commutator within 8ε of a scalar. Second, Fourier concentration on the finite Weyl group produces a nearby local Clifford at each party. Third, the quantized overlap of stabilizer states separates distinct product-Clifford branches by the uniform gap d_p . Once the correct exact branch is known, the AME second moment gives the collective residual estimate in (1.3). The radius is a certified lower bound, not an optimality claim.

Here approximation refers to the state-vector defect of a product unitary acting on an exact code state. This differs from approximate Eastin–Knill results, where error correction itself is relaxed; see, for example, [Ale25]. The two questions share the same fault-tolerance motivation but control different errors.

An exact product-unitary intertwiner between two states transfers this result without changing the constants (Corollary 6.8).

The two headline proof branches are independent. Support geometry first recovers every Weyl axis, which yields exact rigidity and then the transition-map and endomorphism structure. Separately, the same support geometry gives correctable regions, which feed the robust rounding theorem. The comparison estimates in Appendix B are supplementary and are not used to prove either branch.

Transition maps and the remaining obstruction

The support bijections retain how the local Weyl frames are related. For an $(m + 1)$ -party support A , projection at party i gives a bijection $p_i : L_\psi(A) \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^2$. The maps

$$M_A(i, j) = p_j p_i^{-1}$$

are the usual operator-pushing maps between the local Weyl-label spaces. Their compositions around closed paths are holonomies.

Theorem 1.4 (Classification by minimum-support transition maps). Let $m \geq 2$. After a fixed party relabelling, two stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ states are LU equivalent exactly when their systems of minimum-support transition maps are equivalent by local trace-symplectic changes of Weyl frame. For one state, if $\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi)$ is the group of compatible local symplectic automorphisms of the transition system and Γ_ψ its fixed-party projective product-unitary symmetry group, then

$$1 \longrightarrow L_\psi \longrightarrow \Gamma_\psi \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi) \longrightarrow 1$$

is exact. When q is prime, $\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi)$ is the determinant-one unit group of the local endomorphism algebra described in Section 5.

The invariant is also effective. After fixing any half-set of parties, only the m minimum supports obtained by adjoining one complementary party are needed: their supported label groups form a direct sum equal to the full stabilizer label space, and no smaller collection of minimum-support subgroups can span it (Proposition 4.1). Fixed-label recognition then enumerates one base symplectic frame and checks each candidate by finite linear algebra. In particular, it is polynomial in m for fixed local dimension. Corollary 4.3 gives the explicit candidate count and the separate cost of unknown party relabelling. Over a prime field, Corollary 4.4 first compares the block-determinant arrays and then replaces enumeration by linear intertwining equations for $(m - 1)^2$ fundamental four-cycles and the single condition $\det A = 1$. The common centralizer of these cycles is intrinsic: it is the algebra of block-diagonal one-party label endomorphisms preserving the stabilizer space. In prime local dimension this algebra has five possible types. Its determinant-one units give the compatible symmetry group, while its module action explains the corresponding CSS, Hermitian, and nonsemisimple code structures. A further rigidity phenomenon occurs at low party number: for four and six parties the algebra is necessarily nonscalar. For prime $q \geq 5$, every such state therefore has a noncentral compatible symplectic symmetry. These prime-dimensional refinements do not restrict the all-prime-power LU theorem.

At the dimension-dependent radius

$$\min \left\{ \frac{\tau_p}{8}, \frac{2 \sin(\pi/p)}{4 + 64\sqrt{q}} \right\}, \quad (1.4)$$

the symplectic maps recovered by cleaning already preserve every transition map exactly. This does not yet identify the exact product symmetry. Localized commutators cancel Weyl-translation phases, so they determine the stabilizer label space but not its character. The resulting product-Pauli correction need not be close to the rounded product Clifford. We refer to this as the unresolved stabilizer-character, or product-Pauli phase, correction. Controlling it is the missing ingredient in a party-count-independent global entry radius.

Relation to prior work and contribution

The exact three-cleanable-region Clifford obstruction is due to Pastawski and Yoshida [PY15, Lemma 5], building on stabilizer cleaning [BT09, Lemma 1] and the localization method

behind transversal-gate hierarchy bounds [BK13, JOKY18]. We use only the exact cleaning and localization consequences and prove the leakage estimate, finite Weyl–Fourier rounding, and explicit AME composition here.

For exact LU rigidity, Rains recovered the three Pauli axes from a diagonal correlation tensor, and Van den Nest, Dehaene, and De Moor used that mechanism in a minimum-support criterion for qubit stabilizer states [Rai99, Theorem 13] [VdNDDM05, Theorem 1 and Corollary 1]. Subsequent work developed further sufficient conditions and exposed the limits of the LU–LC conjecture [ZCCC07, GVdN08, JCWY10]. Englbrecht and Kraus classify all qubit stabilizer local symmetries [EK20]. More recently, Claudet and Perdrix gave a graphical characterization using generalized local complementation and a quasi-polynomial decision algorithm, while Burchardt, de Jong, and Vandr  reduced verification to modular linear equations [CP25b, CP25a, BdJV24]. The general qubit problem is now sharply separated from the AME case: LU and LC agree through 26 qubits but already differ at 27 [Cla26]. The present support argument instead uses the AME condition to extend the axis-recovery mechanism to arbitrary additive prime-power stabilizers. Because every minimum support contains the full local Weyl basis, no additional minimum-support hypothesis is required.

Tan proves the general AME–quantum-MDS orbit and symmetry–transversal correspondences [Tan26b, Theorems 3.5 and 3.6] and computes the four-qutrit symmetry and transversal groups [Tan26b, Theorem 5.3]; separate work classifies five-qubit AME states [Tan26a]. To our knowledge, the missing uniform statement was that every factor in an arbitrary additive prime-power stabilizer-AME conversion is Clifford, at every even length for which such a state exists. Our exact result supplies that factorwise statement, a complete transition-map invariant, and the finite recognition bound above. It also identifies, in prime dimension, the intrinsic endomorphism algebra behind the symmetry calculation. To our knowledge, no earlier result forces this algebra to be nonscalar for every four- or six-party stabilizer AME state; Tan’s four-qutrit computation is an important special case. The quantitative result supplies an explicit neighborhood in which an approximate product symmetry can be assigned to an exact Clifford branch, while distinguishing symplectic compatibility from the remaining stabilizer-character correction. No new qualitative transversal-hierarchy obstruction is claimed.

The class continues to acquire nontrivial examples: recent self-dual MDS constructions establish stabilizer $\text{AME}(12, 5)$, $\text{AME}(18, 11)$, and $\text{AME}(18, 13)$ states [BB26]. Our results apply to such states without selecting a CSS, graph-state, or $\mathbb{F}_q$ -linear presentation. Recent work classifies diagonal transversal Clifford groups and characterizes code-preserving Clifford circuits for broader binary code families and circuit models [DB25, Alb26]; here the input is instead the maximal entanglement of one stabilizer state, and the conclusion begins with an arbitrary product unitary.

The stabilizer assumption is essential to the discrete transition system. General AME families can contain infinitely many LU classes; Ramadas and Lakshminarayan give an orthogonal-array criterion producing such families [RL25, Theorem 1 and Corollary 1]. Perfect-tensor operator pushing and the encoder interpretation are used explicitly in holographic codes [PYHP15, Eq. (2.3) and Section 5.7].

Organization

Section 2 fixes the additive stabilizer conventions and derives the AME support formula. Sections 3 and 4 prove exact rigidity, the transition-map classification, and the encoder corollary. Section 5 gives the endomorphism-algebra refinement and the low-party theorem in prime dimension. Section 6 proves cleaning-based rounding, robust transition compatibility, and the stabilizer-character obstruction. Section 7 summarizes the scaling and open problem.

The appendices prove the five-type module claims (Appendix A), collect comparison bounds (Appendix B; not needed for the main theorems), and state the trust boundary (Ap-

pendix C).

2 Stabilizer AME support geometry

Let $q = p^e$ and fix the additive character $\chi(a) = \exp(2\pi i \operatorname{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q/\mathbb{F}_p}(a)/p)$. On the standard basis of $\mathbb{C}^q$, indexed by $\mathbb{F}_q$, put

$$X(a)|x\rangle = |x + a\rangle, \quad Z(b)|x\rangle = \chi(bx)|x\rangle.$$

For $v = (a, b) \in \mathbb{F}_q^2$, write $W_v = X(a)Z(b)$, with any fixed consistent phase convention when only its projective axis is used. The q^2 single-party operators W_v form an orthogonal basis of the single-party Hilbert–Schmidt space. A unitary is Clifford when conjugation permutes their projective axes $\mathbb{C}W_v$.

The label-space commutator is measured by the *trace-symplectic pairing*

$$[v, w] = \operatorname{Tr}_{\mathbb{F}_q/\mathbb{F}_p}(ab' - ba') \in \mathbb{F}_p, \quad v = (a, b), \quad w = (a', b').$$

After choosing dual $\mathbb{F}_p$ -bases of $\mathbb{F}_q$, this Weyl system is the Pauli system of e p -level factors. Its projective Clifford normalizer has the standard exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_p^{2e} \longrightarrow \operatorname{PCliff}(q) \longrightarrow \operatorname{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p) \longrightarrow 1, \quad (2.1)$$

including $p = 2$: the kernel is the projective Pauli group, and every trace-symplectic $\mathbb{F}_p$ -linear label map has a Clifford lift [DDM03, HDDM05].

For n parties, a pure stabilizer state is fixed by an abelian Pauli group $\mathcal{S}$ of order q^n . Its projective label group $L \leq (\mathbb{F}_q^2)^n$, viewed additively over $\mathbb{F}_p$, is maximal isotropic for the trace-symplectic form. This is the standard arbitrary-additive prime-power stabilizer correspondence [KKKS06, Theorems 13 and 15]. For each $\ell \in L$, write the stabilizer lift as $\widetilde{W}_\ell = \alpha_\ell W_\ell$, where $\alpha_\ell \neq 0$. These phases encode the joint eigenvalue assignment on L , relative to the fixed Weyl convention; we call that assignment the *stabilizer character*. Then

$$|\psi\rangle\langle\psi| = q^{-n} \sum_{\ell \in L} \widetilde{W}_\ell. \quad (2.2)$$

If A is a party set, put

$$L(A) = \{\ell \in L : \operatorname{supp}(\ell) \subseteq A\}.$$

Weyl orthogonality and partial trace give

$$\rho_A^\psi = q^{-|A|} \sum_{\ell \in L(A)} \widetilde{W}_\ell. \quad (2.3)$$

In particular, ρ_A^ψ is maximally mixed exactly when $L(A) = \{0\}$. Thus a stabilizer state on $2m$ parties is AME exactly when it has no nonidentity stabilizer label supported on at most m parties.

Equations (2.2)–(2.3) are the only state-specific input to the exact rigidity theorem. The same support geometry also identifies any chosen party as the logical leg of a one-qudit stabilizer encoder on the remaining $2m - 1$ parties. The resulting code has parameters $[[2m - 1, 1, m]]_q$: erasure of at most $m - 1$ physical parties is correctable because the complementary reductions of the AME state are maximally mixed. We use this encoder interpretation twice, first for the exact transversal consequence and then for quantitative cleaning.

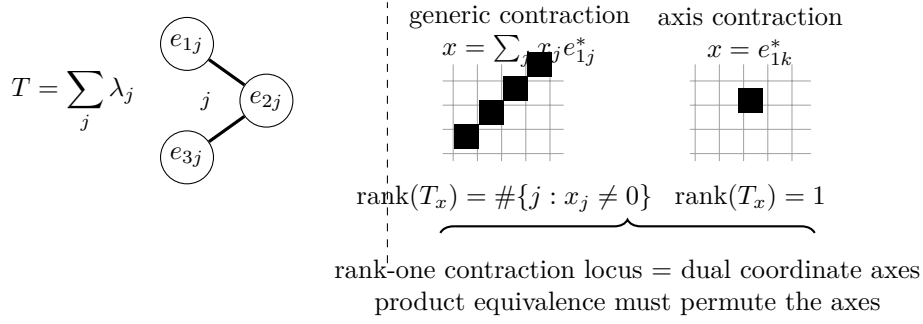


Figure 1: A diagonal tensor with all coefficients nonzero exposes its own axes. Contracting one leg against x and flattening the remainder gives rank equal to the number of nonzero coordinates of x , so the rank-one contraction locus is exactly the set of dual coordinate axes. For an $(m+1)$ -party AME marginal in local Hilbert–Schmidt spaces, the recovered axes are the local Weyl axes, and a product conjugation must permute them.

3 Complete Weyl-basis marginals and LU rigidity

We first isolate the linear-algebra statement that recovers a diagonal tensor’s coordinate axes. It is the complete-Weyl-basis counterpart of the three-Pauli argument in [Rai99, VdNDDM05]. The statement itself is classical: it is Jennrich’s uniqueness theorem for trilinear decompositions, published in [Har70, §V] and there credited to Jennrich, whose conclusion that the factor matrices agree up to one permutation and compensating diagonal scalings is the monomial property below. It is the full-column-rank case of Kruskal’s condition [Kru77], extended to arbitrarily many factors in [SB00]; see [KB09, §3.2] for the attribution and for a survey of the uniqueness theory. We give a short self-contained proof because the contraction argument is the one used in Proposition 3.2, and claim no novelty for either the statement or the proof.

Lemma 3.1 (Diagonal-tensor axes). Let $r \geq 3$, let $E_1, \dots, E_r$ be N -dimensional complex inner product spaces, and choose orthonormal bases $\{e_{ij} : 1 \leq j \leq N\}$. If

$$T = \sum_{j=1}^N \lambda_j e_{1j} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{rj}, \quad \lambda_j \neq 0, \quad (3.1)$$

then the coordinate axes in every E_i are intrinsic to T . Consequently, a product of invertible linear maps carrying one tensor of the form (3.1) to another is monomial in the displayed bases.

Proof. For nonzero $x = \sum_j x_j e_{1j}^*$, contract the first factor against x . The result is

$$T_x = \sum_j \lambda_j x_j e_{2j} \otimes \cdots \otimes e_{rj}.$$

Flattening from E_2 to $E_3 \otimes \cdots \otimes E_r$ gives a matrix of rank $\#\{j : x_j \neq 0\}$. Thus T_x has rank one exactly when the ray of x is a dual coordinate axis. Product equivalence preserves this projective rank-one contraction locus. The inner products identify the recovered dual axes with the coordinate axes in the first factor. Apply the same argument in every factor. $\square$

To avoid repeatedly stating the matched-basis condition, call an operator on $r \geq 3$ qudits *Weyl-diagonal with complete local support* if there is a q^2 -element set P , a distinguished element $0 \in P$, and bijections $f_i : P \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^2$ with $f_i(0) = 0$, for which

$$R = \sum_{v \in P} \lambda_v \bigotimes_{i=1}^r W_{f_i(v)}, \quad \lambda_v \neq 0. \quad (3.2)$$

The coefficients need not be equal. What matters is that the same q^2 -element index set runs bijectively through the complete local Weyl basis at every party. Neither P nor the bijections need be $\mathbb{F}_q$ -linear.

Proposition 3.2 (Complete Weyl-basis marginal criterion). Let R and R' be Weyl-diagonal operators with complete local support on the same $r \geq 3$ parties, possibly with different indexing sets, bijections, and coefficients. If

$$R' = (U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_r) R (U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_r)^\dagger,$$

then every U_i is Clifford.

Proof. View R and R' as tensors in the local Hilbert–Schmidt spaces. After replacing W_v by the orthonormal basis $q^{-1/2}W_v$ and absorbing the common normalization into the coefficients, both have the form in Lemma 3.1, with $N = q^2$. Local conjugation acts invertibly on each factor, so it must permute the Weyl axes. It fixes the identity operator and hence the identity axis. It therefore permutes the nonidentity projective Weyl operators, which is exactly the single-qudit Clifford condition. $\square$

Corollary 3.3 (Marginal-cover rigidity). Let $|\psi\rangle, |\phi\rangle$ be n -qudit states and suppose a product unitary carries $|\psi\rangle$ to $|\phi\rangle$ up to phase, any party permutation having first been absorbed by relabelling $|\phi\rangle$, so that the two states are indexed by the same parties. If every party belongs to a set S of at least three parties for which both reduced operators ρ_S^ψ and ρ_S^ϕ are Weyl-diagonal with complete local support, then every local factor is Clifford.

Proof. Partial trace gives a product-unitary equivalence of the two reduced operators on each chosen S . Apply Proposition 3.2; the chosen sets cover all parties. $\square$

Proposition 3.4 (Stabilizer-AME support theorem). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer AME($2m, q$) state, and let A be any $m + 1$ parties. Then

$$|L(A)| = q^2.$$

Every nonidentity label in $L(A)$ has support exactly A , and for each $i \in A$ the coordinate projection

$$p_i : L(A) \longrightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^2$$

is bijective.

Proof. The projective label group L has order q^{2m} . Restrict its labels to the $m - 1$ parties outside A . The target has order $q^{2(m-1)}$, and the kernel is $L(A)$; hence

$$|L(A)| \geq q^{2m}/q^{2(m-1)} = q^2. \tag{3.3}$$

Fix $i \in A$. A label in the kernel of p_i is supported on the m -set $A \setminus \{i\}$. The AME condition and (2.3) exclude every such nonidentity stabilizer, so p_i is injective. Its codomain has order q^2 , giving the reverse inequality in (3.3) and hence bijectivity. The same no-small-support argument shows that every nonidentity element of $L(A)$ has full support A . $\square$

Proposition 3.5 (A stabilizer-AME marginal fixes the local Weyl axes). Let $|\psi\rangle, |\phi\rangle$ be stabilizer AME($2m, q$) states. If a product unitary on an $(m + 1)$ -set A carries ρ_A^ψ to ρ_A^ϕ , then every local factor on A is Clifford.

Proof. By (2.3),

$$\rho_A^\psi = q^{-|A|} \sum_{\ell \in L_\psi(A)} \widetilde{W}_\ell.$$

Index this sum by $P = L_\psi(A)$. Proposition 3.4 says that every coordinate projection $P \rightarrow \mathbb{F}_q^2$ is bijective. Relative to the fixed Weyl convention, each stabilizer lift contributes a nonzero coefficient. Thus ρ_A^ψ is Weyl-diagonal with complete local support in the sense of (3.2), and the same holds for ρ_A^ϕ . Apply Proposition 3.2. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Absorb the party permutation by relabelling $|\phi\rangle$. Partial trace gives a product-unitary equivalence $\rho_A^\psi \sim \rho_A^\phi$ for every $(m+1)$ -set A . Given a party i , choose such a set containing it and apply Proposition 3.5. Thus every U_i is Clifford. $\square$

4 Minimum-support transition maps and encoder consequences

The same support calculation recovers standard quantum-MDS structure. If $|A| \leq m$, the AME condition gives $L(A) = \{0\}$. If $|A| > m$, then $\rho_{A^c}^\psi$ is maximally mixed, so purity of the global state gives $\text{Tr}((\rho_A^\psi)^2) = q^{-(2m-|A|)}$. On the other hand, (2.3) and Weyl orthogonality give $\text{Tr}((\rho_A^\psi)^2) = q^{-|A|}|L(A)|$. Hence, for every party set A ,

$$|L(A)| = q^{2 \max(|A|-m, 0)}. \quad (4.1)$$

Möbius inversion is the stabilizer-state specialization of the quantum-MDS Shor–Laflamme distribution of Huber and Grassl [HG20, Theorems 8 and 9]; in particular the number of weight- $m+1$ projective stabilizers is $\binom{2m}{m+1}(q^2-1)$. The following systematic form strengthens minimum-weight generation: recognition needs only m of these supports, and that number is optimal among spanning families of minimum-support subgroups.

Proposition 4.1 (Half-set systematic decomposition). Fix an m -party set B , and let $P_j = \mathbb{F}_q^2$ be the local label space at party j . The coordinate projection

$$\text{pr}_{B^c} : L \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{j \notin B} P_j$$

is an isomorphism of additive groups. Hence there is a unique $\mathbb{F}_p$ -linear map

$$K_B : \bigoplus_{j \notin B} P_j \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in B} P_i$$

whose graph is L . For the direct-sum trace-symplectic forms it satisfies

$$[K_B x, K_B y]_B = -[x, y]_{B^c}.$$

After local $\mathbb{F}_p$ -bases are chosen, row reduction therefore puts any row-generator check matrix for L , ordered as B, B^c , in systematic form $[K_B^T \mid I]$; here K_B acts on column vectors. Moreover, if $I \subseteq B$, $J \subseteq B^c$, and $|I| = |J|$, then the party-block submatrix

$$K_{I,J} : \bigoplus_{j \in J} P_j \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in I} P_i$$

is an isomorphism. Conversely, a maximal isotropic subspace of the form $\text{graph}(K_B)$ is the label space of a stabilizer AME state exactly when all these party-aligned square block maps are

isomorphisms. Moreover, $K_{I,J}$ is invertible if and only if the complementary block $K_{B \setminus I, B^c \setminus J}$ is invertible. Thus it suffices to test one representative of each complementary pair.

For each $j \notin B$, put $A_j = B \cup \{j\}$. The inverse image of the j -th coordinate summand is $L(A_j)$, and therefore

$$L = \bigoplus_{j \notin B} L(A_j).$$

Thus these m minimum-support subgroups determine the full stabilizer label group. Moreover, no collection of fewer than m minimum-support subgroups can span L .

Proof. The kernel of pr_{B^c} is $L(B) = \{0\}$ by the AME support condition. Its domain and codomain both have order q^{2m} , so it is an isomorphism. This gives the graph map K_B and the systematic check-matrix form. Since L is isotropic, evaluating the ambient direct-sum symplectic form on $(K_B x, x)$ and $(K_B y, y)$ gives the displayed identity.

For the block statement, let $S = I \cup (B^c \setminus J)$, so $|S| = m$. Projection $L \rightarrow \bigoplus_{s \in S} P_s$ is an isomorphism by the same kernel-and-order argument. If x is supported on J and $K_{I,J} x = 0$, then $(K_B x, x) \in L$ projects to zero on S . Thus $x = 0$. The source and target of $K_{I,J}$ have equal dimension, so the block map is an isomorphism.

Conversely, every m -party set has the form $I \cup (B^c \setminus J)$ with $|I| = |J|$. The kernel of projection from $\text{graph}(K_B)$ to this set is naturally $\ker K_{I,J}$. If all the displayed block maps are isomorphisms, every half-set projection is therefore injective and hence bijective. Equivalently, there is no nonzero stabilizer label supported on at most m parties, which is the stabilizer AME condition.

For complementarity, $K_{I,J}$ is invertible exactly when $K_B(\bigoplus_{j \in J} P_j)$ is transverse to $\bigoplus_{i \in B \setminus I} P_i$. Taking symplectic orthogonal complements and using the anti-symplectic identity for K_B gives the same condition for $K_{B \setminus I, B^c \setminus J}$.

The inverse image of the j -th coordinate summand consists exactly of the labels supported on $B \cup \{j\}$. Pulling back the coordinate direct sum gives the displayed decomposition.

Every minimum-support subgroup has order q^2 by Proposition 3.4. A sum of r such subgroups has order at most q^{2r} , whereas $|L| = q^{2m}$. Spanning L therefore requires $r \geq m$. $\square$

We now prove the transition-map classification stated in the introduction. Regard each local label group

$$P_i = \mathbb{F}_q^{2e}$$

as a $2e$ -dimensional trace-symplectic space over $\mathbb{F}_p$. For every $(m+1)$ -set A and $i, j \in A$, the support theorem defines the operator-pushing transition

$$M_A(i, j) = p_j p_i^{-1} : P_i \longrightarrow P_j.$$

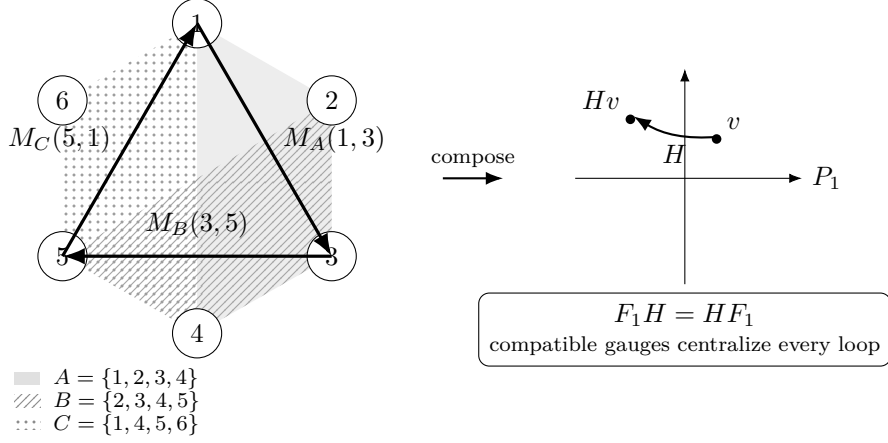


Figure 2: Operator pushing on minimum supports, shown for six parties. Each $(m + 1)$ -party support identifies the local Weyl-label planes of its parties through the bijective projections of the support theorem; overlapping supports compose to a loop whose holonomy $H = M_C M_B M_A$ is a linear map of the base plane, carrying a label v of the base plane to Hv . A local frame change is compatible precisely when it intertwines every transition; for one state over a prime field, its base block centralizes every loop holonomy.

For two states ψ, ϕ on the same labelled parties, a *symplectic equivalence of the transition systems* is a tuple $F_i \in \text{Sp}(P_i)$ satisfying

$$F_j M_A^\psi(i, j) = M_A^\phi(i, j) F_i \quad \text{for every } A \text{ and } i, j \in A. \quad (4.2)$$

Here $\text{Sp}(P_i) = \text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ is the action induced by the standard additive local Clifford group.

For one state, define

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma_\psi &= \{[U] \in \text{PU}(q^{2m}) : U = U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_{2m}, U|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{C}|\psi\rangle\}, \\ \text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi) &= \{(F_i) \in \prod_i \text{Sp}(P_i) : F_j M_A(i, j) = M_A(i, j) F_i \text{ for all } A, i, j \in A\}. \end{aligned}$$

Here the subscript tr refers to the transition system; this group is also the linear image of the fixed-party transversal symmetries. Theorem 1.1 and the Clifford sequence (2.1) give a well-defined homomorphism

$$\lambda_\psi : \Gamma_\psi \longrightarrow \text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi), \quad [U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_{2m}] \longmapsto (\overline{U}_i)_i,$$

where $\overline{U}_i$ is the induced symplectic label map. A product decomposition is unique up to one-site scalars, which do not change $\overline{U}_i$. The injection $L_\psi \hookrightarrow \Gamma_\psi$ sends a label ℓ to the projective Pauli $[W_\ell]$.

Lemma 4.2 (Pauli phase correction). Let ψ and ϕ be stabilizer states with Lagrangian label groups L_ψ and L_ϕ . If a product Clifford U induces a symplectic label map carrying L_ψ onto L_ϕ , then there is a product Pauli W_v such that $W_v U|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{C}|\phi\rangle$. If L_ϕ is the label space of a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state, then for any prescribed m -party set C , the correcting label v may be chosen uniquely with support contained in C . No prescribed set of fewer than m parties can support corrections for every possible character discrepancy.

Proof. The state $U|\psi\rangle$ is stabilized on the same Pauli axes as $|\phi\rangle$, possibly with a different stabilizer character. The trace-symplectic pairing identifies the ambient label space modulo $L_\phi = L_\phi^\perp$ with the character dual of L_ϕ . Choose v whose pairing character is the inverse of

the discrepancy. Conjugation by the product Pauli W_v cancels it. The corrected state and $|\phi\rangle$ therefore lie in the same one-dimensional joint stabilizer eigenspace.

For the final statement, projection $L_\phi \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in C} P_i$ is an isomorphism by Proposition 4.1. The trace-symplectic form on the latter space is nondegenerate. Hence pairing with labels supported on C identifies $\bigoplus_{i \in C} P_i$ with the full character dual of L_ϕ . Exactly one such label realizes the inverse discrepancy. If a prescribed support has $r < m$ parties, its label space has only q^{2r} elements, whereas the character group of L_ϕ has q^{2m} . It therefore cannot realize every discrepancy. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.4. First fix the party labels. A block symplectic map $F = \bigoplus_i F_i$ carrying L_ψ to L_ϕ carries every supported subgroup $L_\psi(A)$ to $L_\phi(A)$. Writing these subgroups as graphs through any projection p_i gives exactly (4.2).

Conversely, suppose (4.2) holds. Fix A and $i \in A$. Every element of $L_\psi(A)$ is uniquely determined by its i -coordinate, and the equations with $j \in A$ show that its image under F is the unique element of $L_\phi(A)$ with i -coordinate $F_i p_i(\ell)$. Thus $FL_\psi(A) = L_\phi(A)$. Since the $(m+1)$ -supported subgroups generate the full label groups by Proposition 4.1, $FL_\psi = L_\phi$.

Sequence (2.1) supplies local Clifford lifts of the F_i , and Lemma 4.2 supplies the product-Pauli correction. Hence an equivalence of transition systems lifts to an LC equivalence. The reverse implication follows from the induced label action, and Theorem 1.1 replaces LC by LU. A party permutation is absorbed by relabelling first.

For automorphisms, λ_ψ is surjective by the same lifting and phase-correction argument. Its kernel consists of projective product Paulis by (2.1). Such a Pauli fixes the state ray exactly when its label lies in $L_\psi^\perp = L_\psi$. Thus the displayed injection of L_ψ identifies it with $\ker \lambda_\psi$, proving exactness. $\square$

Corollary 4.3 (Finite recognition bound). Let ψ and ϕ be stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ states, $q = p^e$ and $m \geq 2$, given by check matrices for their additive label spaces. With the party labels fixed, choose any m -party set B , and write their half-set systematic maps as K_B^ψ, K_B^ϕ . The states are LU equivalent if and only if there are $F_i \in \text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$ satisfying

$$\left(\bigoplus_{i \in B} F_i \right) K_B^\psi = K_B^\phi \left(\bigoplus_{j \notin B} F_j \right). \quad (4.3)$$

This can be decided by testing at most

$$|\text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)| = p^{e^2} \prod_{r=1}^e (p^{2r} - 1)$$

base symplectic frames. In the arithmetic-operation model over $\mathbb{F}_p$, each candidate requires polynomial work in the check-matrix size. The stabilizer phases need not be supplied for this decision: Lemma 4.2 guarantees a character repair after the label spaces are matched. If the two characters are supplied, then for any chosen m -party set the repair is the unique Pauli label on that carrier realizing their discrepancy, and it is found by one linear solve. For prime q , the number of base candidates is $|\text{SL}_2(q)| = q(q^2 - 1)$. In particular, fixed-label recognition is polynomial in m for fixed local dimension q . With classical cubic matrix arithmetic, a concrete bound is

$$O((me)^3 + |\text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)| m^2 e^3)$$

$\mathbb{F}_p$ -operations.

If the party relabelling is unknown, exhaustive search introduces at most a factor $(2m)!$. For one state,

$$|\Gamma_\psi| = q^{2m} |\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi)| \leq q^{2m} |\text{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)|.$$

Proof. Mapping the two graph subspaces into one another is exactly the block equation (4.3). By Theorem 1.4 and Lemma 4.2, its locally symplectic solutions are exactly the LU equivalences.

Write K_{ij}^ψ and K_{ij}^ϕ for the party blocks. They are invertible by Proposition 4.1. Choose $i_0 \in B$ and $j_0 \notin B$. Once F_{j_0} is fixed, the (i, j_0) -blocks of (4.3) determine every F_i , and the (i_0, j) -blocks then determine every remaining F_j . Enumerate $F_{j_0} \in \mathrm{Sp}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p)$, test that the propagated frames are symplectic, and check all m^2 block equations. Forming the systematic maps and carrying out these checks is finite-field linear algebra polynomial in the input size and gives the displayed arithmetic bound. The $2m - 1$ propagation equations form a spanning tree in the complete bipartite party graph; the remaining $m^2 - (2m - 1) = (m - 1)^2$ checks are its fundamental four-cycles. Enumerating party permutations gives the stated factor. The group-order bound follows from the exact sequence in Theorem 1.4 and injectivity of evaluation at the base frame. $\square$

Corollary 4.4 (Prime-field recognition by fundamental cycles). Let ψ, ϕ be stabilizer $\mathrm{AME}(2m, q)$ states with $m \geq 2$, assume $q = p$, and fix a labelled split $B \sqcup B^c$. Write $G = K_B^\psi$, $H = K_B^\phi$, and choose $b \in B$ and $c \in B^c$. For $i \neq b$ and $j \neq c$, define

$$Q_{ij}^G = G_{bj}G_{ij}^{-1}G_{ic}G_{bc}^{-1} \in \mathrm{GL}_2(q),$$

and define Q_{ij}^H similarly. Then ψ and ϕ are fixed-party LU equivalent if and only if

$$\det G_{ij} = \det H_{ij} \quad \text{for all } i, j$$

and there is an $A \in \mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ such that

$$AQ_{ij}^G = Q_{ij}^H A \quad \text{for all } i \neq b, j \neq c.$$

Thus prime-field recognition reduces to homogeneous linear equations in the four entries of A , followed by the single quadratic condition $\det A = 1$. Equivalently, the block-determinant array together with the simultaneous $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$ -conjugacy class of the ordered fundamental holonomies is a complete fixed-party LU invariant. The corresponding symmetry algebra and its five prime-field types are identified intrinsically in Section 5.

Proof. Suppose first that

$$A_i G_{ij} = H_{ij} D_j$$

for local $A_i, D_j \in \mathrm{SL}_2(q)$. Taking determinants gives the block-determinant equalities. Multiplying around the displayed four-cycle gives $Q_{ij}^H = A_b Q_{ij}^G A_b^{-1}$, so $A = A_b$ satisfies the intertwining equations.

Conversely, start from such an A and set

$$D_j = H_{bj}^{-1} A G_{bj}, \quad A_i = H_{ic} D_c G_{ic}^{-1}.$$

The determinant equalities put every D_j and A_i in $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$. The base row and base column equations hold by construction. Each remaining equation $A_i G_{ij} = H_{ij} D_j$ is equivalent, after substitution, to $A Q_{ij}^G = Q_{ij}^H A$. Hence the systematic matrices are locally symplectically equivalent, and Corollary 4.3 lifts this to LU equivalence. Taking $G = H$ gives the centralizer statement. $\square$

4.1 Encoder consequences

Proof of Corollary 1.2. The input marginal of each AME Choi state is $q^{-1}I$, so one-leg reshaping gives an isometry. The projection of its stabilizer label group onto the input Weyl-label space is surjective: otherwise a nonzero local label orthogonal to the image would lie in the maximal isotropic space $L^\perp = L$, contradicting the absence of a one-party stabilizer. The kernel therefore has q^{2m-2} elements and stabilizes the image, making it a one-logical-qudit stabilizer code. AME corrects erasure of any $m-1$ outputs, so its distance is at least m ; the quantum Singleton bound gives equality. This is the standard perfect-tensor/quantum-MDS correspondence used in [Tan26b, Theorems 3.5 and 3.6].

Let $|\Phi\rangle = q^{-1/2} \sum_x |x, x\rangle$, and use the Choi convention $|\psi\rangle = (I \otimes V_\psi)|\Phi\rangle$ and $|\phi\rangle = (I \otimes V_\phi)|\Phi\rangle$. Writing $U_{\text{phys}} = \bigotimes_i U_i$, the relation $U_{\text{phys}} V_\psi = V_\phi L$ gives

$$(I \otimes U_{\text{phys}})|\psi\rangle = (L^T \otimes I)|\phi\rangle.$$

Hence

$$((L^T)^{-1} \otimes U_{\text{phys}})|\psi\rangle = |\phi\rangle.$$

Theorem 1.1 makes every displayed local factor Clifford. Entrywise conjugation preserves the finite-field Weyl group, since $\overline{X(a)} = X(a)$ and $\overline{Z(b)} = Z(-b)$; it therefore preserves the Clifford normalizer. Taking adjoints preserves the normalizer as well, and $U^T = (\overline{U})^\dagger$. Thus transposition preserves the finite-field Clifford group, and L is Clifford. $\square$

The recognition procedure is constructive for these encoders. Given check matrices for the two normalized Choi states, Corollary 4.3 decides whether a transversal conversion exists and returns compact symplectic-frame witnesses within the same arithmetic bound. If full stabilizer tableaux and chosen Clifford lifts are also supplied, one further linear solve returns a compact Clifford–Pauli conversion: the reference frame R gives logical frame $(R^T)^{-1}$, and Lemma 4.2 allows the character repair to be supported on any prescribed m physical outputs. Thus the repair need not alter the logical factor. Moreover, m is the smallest size of a prescribed carrier that works uniformly for every discrepancy. This bound does not include expansion into dense unitary matrices.

5 The local endomorphism algebra

The preceding results solve LU equivalence for every prime power. This section extracts additional structure from the same systematic matrix. The algebraic description below is valid over the underlying prime field; the five-type classification and its code interpretations specialize explicitly to prime local dimension. None of this section is needed for the robust rounding theorem.

Let $m \geq 2$, and let $L \subseteq \bigoplus_i P_i$ be the label space of a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state, where each P_i is regarded as a $2e$ -dimensional $\mathbb{F}_p$ -space. Define

$$\mathcal{E}_L = \left\{ (T_i)_i \in \prod_i \text{End}_{\mathbb{F}_p}(P_i) : \left(\bigoplus_i T_i \right) L \subseteq L \right\}. \quad (5.1)$$

Thus $\mathcal{E}_L$ is the algebra of block-diagonal, one-party label endomorphisms preserving L .

Theorem 5.1 (Endomorphism algebra from fundamental cycles). Fix a half-set $B \sqcup B^c$, write $G = K_B$, and choose $b \in B$ and $c \in B^c$. For $i \neq b$ and $j \neq c$, put

$$Q_{ij} = G_{bj} G_{ij}^{-1} G_{ic} G_{bc}^{-1} \in \text{GL}_{2e}(\mathbb{F}_p).$$

Evaluation at party b is an algebra isomorphism

$$\mathcal{E}_L \cong \text{Cent}_{\text{End}_{\mathbb{F}_p}(P_b)}\{Q_{ij} : i \neq b, j \neq c\}. \quad (5.2)$$

Under this isomorphism, the compatible local symplectic automorphisms are the units whose propagated components preserve the symplectic form at every party. If $q = p$, this condition is simply

$$\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi) \cong \{T \in \mathcal{E}_L : \det T_b = 1\}. \quad (5.3)$$

In particular, the abstract algebra does not depend on the chosen half-set or base parties.

Proof. A block-diagonal endomorphism, written as $(A_i)_{i \in B}$ and $(D_j)_{j \in B^c}$, preserves the graph of G exactly when

$$A_i G_{ij} = G_{ij} D_j \quad (i \in B, j \in B^c). \quad (5.4)$$

Every block G_{ij} is invertible by Proposition 4.1. Once $A_b = A$ is fixed, the base row and column force

$$D_j = G_{bj}^{-1} A G_{bj}, \quad A_i = G_{ic} D_c G_{ic}^{-1}. \quad (5.5)$$

The remaining equations are precisely $A Q_{ij} = Q_{ij} A$. Evaluation at b is therefore bijective onto the common centralizer, and (5.5) shows that it respects addition and multiplication.

An automorphism is compatible exactly when every propagated component in (5.5) is symplectic. For $q = p$, all components are conjugate 2×2 matrices and $\text{Sp}_2(q) = \text{SL}_2(q)$, so this is equivalent to $\det T_b = 1$. For $e > 1$, one must retain all transported symplectic-form conditions; a single determinant condition is not sufficient. Finally, the definition in (5.1) is independent of the systematic presentation. $\square$

For prime dimension, Theorem 5.1 replaces the former list of unrelated group orders by a classification of one algebra. It also explains what additional code structure each nonscalar case supplies.

Corollary 5.2 (Five prime-field algebra types). Assume $m \geq 2$ and $q = p$, and put $d = \gcd(2, q - 1)$. Exactly one row of Table 1 applies. The middle two columns give $\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi)$ and its order, and

$$|\Gamma_\psi| = q^{2m} |\text{Aut}_{\text{tr}}(\psi)|.$$

After compatible local coordinates are chosen, the last column gives the code or module structure forced by $\mathcal{E}_L$.

$\mathcal{E}_L$	compatible group	order	resulting structure
$M_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$	$\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$	$q(q^2 - 1)$	$\mathbb{F}_q^2 \otimes C$, where C is a weighted self-dual classical MDS code; an MDS–CSS stabilizer after local symplectic coordinate changes
$\mathbb{F}_q I$	center of $\mathrm{SL}_2(q)$	d	no additional linear structure is forced
$\mathbb{F}_q \times \mathbb{F}_q$	split norm-one torus	$q - 1$	two weighted-dual classical MDS codes on complementary local axes; an MDS–CSS stabilizer after local symplectic coordinate changes
$\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$	field norm-one torus	$q + 1$	an $\mathbb{F}_{q^2}$ -linear MDS code, weighted Hermitian self-dual in compatible coordinates
$\mathbb{F}_q[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$	determinant-one units	qd	a free rank- m dual-number module for which every half-set projection is an isomorphism

Table 1: The five prime-field endomorphism algebras, their determinant-one unit groups, and the code structures they force.

Proof of Corollary 5.2. If every fundamental holonomy is scalar, its common centralizer is $M_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$. Otherwise choose a nonscalar holonomy Q . Its centralizer is the quadratic algebra $\mathbb{F}_q[Q]$. If another holonomy does not commute with Q , the common centralizer is scalar; if all holonomies commute, the common centralizer remains $\mathbb{F}_q[Q]$. The three quadratic possibilities are the split algebra, the quadratic field, and the dual numbers. The determinant restricts respectively to the product, the field norm, and $\det(aI + bN) = a^2$ for $N^2 = 0$. This gives the five groups and orders in the table, including characteristic two.

The code interpretations follow from the action of $\mathcal{E}_L$ on the local planes and the fact that every half-set projection of L is an isomorphism. Appendix A gives the module argument. $\square$

The classification is constructive without enumerating a finite group. Indeed, $\mathcal{E}_L$ is the kernel of the homogeneous linear system $[A, Q_{ij}] = 0$ in the four entries of A . Its dimension is 1, 2, or 4; in the middle case the characteristic polynomial of one nonscalar element distinguishes the three quadratic algebras. Propagation by (5.5) then recovers the one-party actions. Thus the recognition calculation also returns the symmetry type and the corresponding code-structure row of Table 1.

The constituent CSS and Hermitian code constructions are standard; see, for example, [KKKS06]. In the qubit case, invariance under a uniform order-three local Clifford was already identified with $\mathbb{F}_4$ -linearity [VdNDDM05, Theorem 2]. Our use of the table is the converse organization specific to stabilizer AME states: the intrinsic endomorphism algebra determines both the compatible group and the code structure. We do not call the dual-number row an MDS code over a ring.

The algebra formulation also reveals a restriction at small party number that is absent from the five-row list.

Theorem 5.3 (Forced endomorphisms for four and six parties). Let $q = p$. For every stabilizer AME($2m, q$) state with $m = 2$ or $m = 3$,

$$\dim_{\mathbb{F}_q} \mathcal{E}_L \geq 2. \quad (5.6)$$

Equivalently, all fundamental four-cycle holonomies commute, so the scalar row of Table 1 cannot occur. If $q \geq 5$, the state consequently has a noncentral compatible local symplectic automorphism.

Proof. For $m = 2$ there is only one fundamental holonomy, whose centralizer has dimension at least two.

Let $m = 3$. Independent invertible changes of block row and column bases put the 3×3 block matrix G in the form

$$N = \begin{pmatrix} I & I & I \\ I & A & B \\ I & C & D \end{pmatrix}. \quad (5.7)$$

These basis changes need not be symplectic. In dimension two, however, every invertible change rescales the alternating form. Pulling the domain and codomain forms through the block-diagonal basis changes therefore turns the anti-symplectic identity for G into the following weighted one. Explicitly, if $N = PGQ$, with $P = \text{diag}(P_i)$ and $Q = \text{diag}(Q_j)$, then

$$S^\top JS = (\det S)J \implies P_i^{-\top} J P_i^{-1} = (\det P_i)^{-1} J, \quad Q_j^\top J Q_j = (\det Q_j) J.$$

Substitution in $G^\top \text{diag}(J)G = -\text{diag}(J)$ gives

$$N^\top \text{diag}(r_0 J, r_1 J, r_2 J)N = -\text{diag}(s_0 J, s_1 J, s_2 J) \quad (5.8)$$

with $r_i = (\det P_i)^{-1}$ and $s_j = \det Q_j$. Applying the same observation to N^{-1} gives $t_j = s_j^{-1}$, so distinct block rows satisfy

$$\sum_{j=0}^2 t_j N_{ij} J N_{kj}^\top = 0 \quad (i \neq k). \quad (5.9)$$

Thus (5.8) gives weighted column orthogonality and (5.9) gives weighted row orthogonality.

Orthogonality of the first two block rows gives

$$t_0 I + t_1 A^\top + t_2 B^\top = 0,$$

so $B \in \text{span}_{\mathbb{F}_q}\{I, A\}$. The first and third rows similarly give $D \in \text{span}\{I, C\}$. Orthogonality of the first two block columns gives

$$r_0 I + r_1 A + r_2 C = 0,$$

so C , and hence D , also lies in $\text{span}\{I, A\}$. All four non-tree blocks commute. In the normalization (5.7), the fundamental holonomies are their inverses, so they commute as well. The common centralizer is therefore at least two-dimensional.

For $q \geq 5$, every determinant-one group attached to a nonscalar row of Table 1 has order strictly larger than $d = \gcd(2, q-1)$, which proves the final assertion. At $q = 3$, for example, the split norm-one group can coincide with the center; this is why the qualification is necessary. $\square$

Thus extra label-space linearity is forced through six parties, without an occurrence or genericity claim for the remaining types.

6 Cleaning-based quantitative rounding

We now turn from exact equivalence to approximate symmetry. Estimating one reduced operator would lose the exponentially small nonidentity signal of a minimum-support marginal. The global argument avoids that loss. Choose one AME party as a logical input. The other $2m-1$ parties form an $[[2m-1, 1, m]]_q$ stabilizer code, and the product of their local factors approximately implements the transpose-inverse of the factor on the chosen party. Three

correctable regions then test that logical action by a nested commutator. Indeed, distance m makes every set of at most $m - 1$ erased physical parties correctable, and the $2m - 1$ physical parties split into regions of sizes $m - 1, m - 1, 1$.

The exact mechanism is standard: the qubit stabilizer cleaning lemma is due to Bravyi and Terhal [BT09, Lemma 1]; in the additive prime-power setting used here, the same cleaning step is the elementary symplectic statement recorded in the proof of Lemma 6.1. Nested-commutator localization underlies the Bravyi–König hierarchy theorem [BK13], and Pastawski–Yoshida prove directly that a transversal logical unitary on three cleanable regions is Clifford [PY15, Lemma 5]. Disjointness gives a complementary exact-code hierarchy bound [JOKY18, Theorem 5]. The point below is therefore not a new qualitative transversal-gate obstruction. It is the robust step: an implementation with leakage error ε forces every nested logical Weyl commutator within 8ε of a scalar, after which a Fourier argument gives an explicit Clifford distance.

For an encoding isometry $V : \mathbb{C}^q \rightarrow \mathcal{H}$, write

$$E(T, L) = q^{-1/2} \|TV - VL\|_{\text{HS}}.$$

It satisfies $E(TS, LM) \leq E(T, L) + E(S, M)$ and $E(T^\dagger, L^\dagger) = E(T, L)$.

Lemma 6.1 (Quantitative cleaning commutator). Let V encode one logical qudit in a stabilizer code whose physical parties have a partition into three correctable regions. Let T be transversal, and suppose $E(T, L) \leq \varepsilon$. For all logical Weyl operators P, Q ,

$$q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \| [L, P], Q - zI \|_{\text{HS}} \leq 8\varepsilon, \quad (6.1)$$

where $[A, B] = ABA^\dagger B^\dagger$.

Proof. Let R_1, R_2, R_3 be the assumed correctable partition. The stabilizer cleaning lemma supplies a representative $\tilde{P}$ of P outside R_1 and a representative $\tilde{Q}$ of Q outside R_2 . For reference, cleaning here is the elementary symplectic statement that the restriction of a normalizer label to a correctable region lies in the restriction of the stabilizer label space; subtracting that stabilizer removes the restriction.

Transversality makes $[T, \tilde{P}]$ supported outside R_1 , so $C = [[T, \tilde{P}], \tilde{Q}]$ is supported on $R_1^c \cap R_2^c = R_3$. The composition rules give

$$E(C, [[L, P], Q]) \leq 4\varepsilon. \quad (6.2)$$

Knill–Laflamme correction on R_3 gives $V^\dagger CV = cI$. Hence the logical nested commutator lies within 4ε of cI . Its normalized Hilbert–Schmidt norm is one, so $|c| \geq 1 - 4\varepsilon$. If $c = 0$, then $\varepsilon \geq 1/4$, and (6.1) is immediate because its left-hand side is at most $2 \leq 8\varepsilon$. Otherwise, replacing c by $c/|c|$ proves (6.1). Notice that C need not preserve the code. Only its scalar compression is used, while (6.2) controls leakage. $\square$

The remaining step is finite-dimensional Fourier concentration. It is stated separately because it is the point where scalar commutators become Clifford axes.

Lemma 6.2 (Nested Weyl commutators round to a Clifford). Let $L \in U(q)$, $q = p^e$, and suppose for all Weyl labels v, w that

$$q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \| [L, W_v], W_w - zI \|_{\text{HS}} \leq \eta.$$

If

$$\eta < \tau_p := \min \left\{ \frac{1}{3}, \frac{\sin(\pi/p)}{2\sqrt{2}} \right\},$$

then some additive one-qudit Clifford K satisfies

$$q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|L - zK\|_{\text{HS}} \leq \eta.$$

Proof. Put $A_v = LW_vL^\dagger$. Conjugation of W_w by W_v changes only its phase, so every $[A_v, W_w]$ is within η of a scalar. We use the following Fourier observation twice. If $A = \sum_a c_a W_a$ is unitary and every $[A, W_w]$ is within η of a scalar, then A lies within η of one Weyl axis. Indeed, with $p_a = |c_a|^2$, the commutator estimate gives

$$\left| \sum_a p_a \chi_w(a) \right| \geq 1 - \eta^2/2.$$

Character orthogonality, averaged over w , yields $\sum_a p_a^2 \geq (1 - \eta^2/2)^2$. Thus $\max_a p_a \geq (1 - \eta^2/2)^2$, which is precisely the asserted normalized distance bound.

Apply the observation to each A_v , and call its unique nearby Weyl label $F(v)$. The exact identity $A_{v+u} \in \mathbb{C}A_vA_u$ puts the axes labelled by $F(v+u)$ and $F(v)+F(u)$ within 3η . Distinct Weyl axes have phase-optimized distance $\sqrt{2}$, so $\eta < 1/3$ makes F additive. Comparing the exact commutator phases is equally direct. Write $\|X\|_2 = q^{-1/2}\|X\|_{\text{HS}}$, and choose phases α, β so that $\|A_v - \alpha W_{F(v)}\|_2 \leq \eta$ and $\|A_u - \beta W_{F(u)}\|_2 \leq \eta$. Unitary invariance and a four-factor telescoping estimate give

$$\begin{aligned} & \|A_v A_u A_v^\dagger A_u^\dagger - W_{F(v)} W_{F(u)} W_{F(v)}^\dagger W_{F(u)}^\dagger\|_2 \\ & \leq \|A_v - \alpha W_{F(v)}\|_2 + \|A_u - \beta W_{F(u)}\|_2 + \|A_v^\dagger - \bar{\alpha} W_{F(v)}^\dagger\|_2 + \|A_u^\dagger - \bar{\beta} W_{F(u)}^\dagger\|_2 \leq 4\eta. \end{aligned}$$

The phases α, β cancel in the commutator. Its two sides are scalar p -th roots of unity: the first has the original Weyl commutator phase, while the second has the phase determined by $F(v), F(u)$. The least nontrivial p -th-root chord is $2 \sin(\pi/p)$, whereas the stated bound gives $4\eta < \sqrt{2} \sin(\pi/p) < 2 \sin(\pi/p)$. The two phases must therefore agree, so F is trace-symplectic.

Choose an additive Clifford K_0 inducing F . Then $K_0^\dagger L$ approximately fixes every Weyl axis, so all its Weyl commutators are within η of scalars. The Fourier observation puts it within η of a Weyl; multiplying that Weyl into K_0 gives the required Clifford. $\square$

Two further estimates turn local Clifford frames into the stated global decomposition. The first separates distinct Clifford images of a stabilizer state by a uniform gap.

Lemma 6.3 (Quantized stabilizer overlap). Let $|\psi\rangle, |\phi\rangle$ be stabilizer states on n qudits of local dimension $q = p^e$, with label groups L_ψ, L_ϕ and stabilizer characters χ_ψ, χ_ϕ . Then

$$|\langle\psi|\phi\rangle|^2 = \begin{cases} |L_\psi \cap L_\phi|/q^n, & \text{if } \chi_\psi = \chi_\phi \text{ on } L_\psi \cap L_\phi, \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

In particular, a product Clifford K either preserves the ray of ψ , or

$$\varepsilon(K) \geq d_p := (2 - 2p^{-1/2})^{1/2}.$$

Proof. Weyl orthogonality and the stabilizer expansions give

$$|\langle\psi|\phi\rangle|^2 = q^{-n} \sum_{\ell \in L_\psi \cap L_\phi} (\chi_\psi \overline{\chi_\phi})(\ell).$$

The summand is a character of the intersection, so the sum is its order when the character is trivial and zero otherwise. Since the intersection has p -power order, every nonunit overlap has modulus at most $p^{-1/2}$. Apply this to $\phi = K\psi$, which is again a stabilizer state. $\square$

The second estimate controls all residual generators at once. Its proof is included because it is a load-bearing part of the headline quantitative theorem; Appendix B gives stronger variants under other hypotheses.

Lemma 6.4 (Balanced-cut comparison). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state with label group L , let $U = \bigotimes_j U_j$ be any product unitary, and write $a_j(v) = q^{-1} \text{Tr}(W_v^\dagger U_j)$. For an m -party set A , define vectors indexed by L by

$$u_A(\ell) = \prod_{j \in A} |a_j(\ell_j)|, \quad v_A(\ell) = \prod_{j \notin A} |a_j(\ell_j)|.$$

Then $\|u_A\| = \|v_A\| = 1$ and

$$|\langle \psi | U | \psi \rangle| \leq \langle u_A, v_A \rangle, \quad \varepsilon(U)^2 \geq \|u_A - v_A\|^2.$$

Proof. Restriction of L to either half is injective because a kernel label would be supported on at most m parties; it is bijective because both groups have order q^{2m} . Weyl Parseval then gives the unit norms. Expanding the stabilizer expectation and taking absolute values termwise gives $|\langle \psi | U | \psi \rangle| \leq \langle u_A, v_A \rangle$; the Weyl index is $-\ell$, up to phase, and $\ell \mapsto -\ell$ is a bijection of L . Since the two vectors are unit, the asserted defect bound follows. $\square$

Proposition 6.5 (Residual stability). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state with $m \geq 2$, and let $U = \bigotimes_j U_j$ be any product unitary. Put

$$\eta_j = 1 - |q^{-1} \text{Tr } U_j|^2, \quad H = \sum_j \eta_j.$$

If $H \leq 1/4$, then

$$\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq H/4.$$

Consequently, suppose $U = \bigotimes_j e^{ih_j}$, where every h_j is traceless Hermitian of spectral spread at most $s \leq \pi$, and put

$$c(s) = \max \left\{ 1 - \frac{s^2}{12}, \frac{4}{\pi^2} \right\}.$$

If $D^2 = \sum_j \|h_j\|_F^2 \leq q/4$, then

$$D \leq 2\sqrt{q/c(s)} \varepsilon(U) \leq \pi\sqrt{q} \varepsilon(U).$$

No bound on $\sum_j \|h_j\|_{\text{op}}$ is assumed.

Proof. Weyl amplitudes and the balanced cut. Choose an m -party set A , use the notation of Lemma 6.4, and abbreviate $u = u_A$, $v = v_A$. Then $\eta_j = 1 - |a_j(0)|^2$, and the lemma gives $\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq \|u - v\|^2$.

Minimum-support witnesses. For each $j \notin A$, labels supported on $A \cup \{j\}$ form the kernel of projection to $A^c \setminus \{j\}$. Projection onto A^c is a bijection, so this kernel has order q^2 . Moreover, evaluation at any coordinate in $A \cup \{j\}$ is injective: an element in its kernel would be supported on at most m parties and hence would vanish by the AME support formula. Evaluation is therefore bijective, and every nonzero label in the kernel has support exactly $A \cup \{j\}$.

For a Weyl label w , let $\ell^{j,w}$ be the unique such label whose j -coordinate is w . Put $\mu_i(v) = |a_i(v)|^2$. The first sum below is exact, while the second is the diagonal part of a product of nonnegative sums:

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{w \neq 0} v(\ell^{j,w})^2 &= \eta_j \prod_{k \in A^c \setminus \{j\}} (1 - \eta_k) \geq \eta_j(1 - H), \\ \sum_{w \neq 0} u(\ell^{j,w})^2 &= \sum_{w \neq 0} \prod_{i \in A} \mu_i(\ell_i^{j,w}) \leq \prod_{i \in A} \sum_{w \neq 0} \mu_i(\ell_i^{j,w}) = \prod_{i \in A} \eta_i. \end{aligned}$$

The corresponding families are disjoint as j varies. The families obtained after exchanging A and A^c also have different supports, so their contributions may be added. Applying $(x-y)^2 \geq x^2/2 - y^2$, first to the families indexed by $j \in A^c$ and then to those indexed by $i \in A$, gives

$$\|u - v\|^2 \geq \frac{1}{2}(1-H)H - m \left(\prod_{i \in A} \eta_i + \prod_{j \in A^c} \eta_j \right).$$

For either half S , $m \prod_{i \in S} \eta_i \leq \eta^{m-1} \sum_{i \in S} \eta_i$, where $\eta = \max_j \eta_j$. Hence

$$\|u - v\|^2 \geq \left(\frac{1}{2}(1-H) - \eta^{m-1} \right) H.$$

For $m \geq 3$ and $H \leq 1/4$, the coefficient is at least $5/16$. For $m = 2$, write $A = \{1, 2\}$, $A^c = \{3, 4\}$, and $P = \eta_1\eta_2 + \eta_3\eta_4$. Using the exact first identity above in the two cut directions gives

$$\|u - v\|^2 \geq H/2 - 3P,$$

while

$$P \leq \frac{(\eta_1 + \eta_2)^2 + (\eta_3 + \eta_4)^2}{4} \leq \frac{H^2}{4}.$$

Therefore $H/2 - 3P \geq H/2 - 3H^2/4 \geq 5H/16$. Thus in all cases $\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq H/4$, proving the first statement.

Spectral contraction. It remains to compare H with D . If X is uniform on the eigenvalues of h_j , then

$$\eta_j = 1 - |\mathbb{E} e^{iX}|^2 = \mathbb{E}[1 - \cos(X - X')] \geq c(s) \frac{\|h_j\|_F^2}{q},$$

using both $\cos x \leq 1 - x^2/2 + x^4/24$ for $|x| \leq s$ and $1 - \cos x \geq 2x^2/\pi^2$ for $|x| \leq \pi$. Conversely $\eta_j \leq \|h_j\|_F^2/q$, so $H \leq D^2/q \leq 1/4$. Combining the inequalities gives $\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq c(s)D^2/(4q)$, which proves the consequence. $\square$

At $\varepsilon = 0$, the first two lemmas in this section recover the three-cleanable-region Clifford conclusion of [PY15, Lemma 5]. Their quantitative combination, and the constants in (6.1), are what will be used here.

The next elementary estimate records the conversion from a nearby unitary axis to a centered Hermitian generator.

Lemma 6.6 (Chords and centered logarithms). Let $V \in U(q)$, and put

$$\delta = q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|V - zI\|_{\text{HS}}.$$

If $\delta < \sqrt{2/q}$, choose a minimizing phase z , write $z^{-1}V = e^{ia}$ using the principal Hermitian logarithm, and set $h = a - q^{-1} \text{Tr}(a)I$. Then the spectrum of a lies in $(-\pi/2, \pi/2)$, the spectral spread of h is at most π , and

$$\|h\|_F \leq \|a\|_F \leq \frac{\pi}{2} \sqrt{q} \delta.$$

Proof. Since the operator norm is at most the Hilbert–Schmidt norm,

$$\|z^{-1}V - I\|_{\text{op}} \leq \|z^{-1}V - I\|_{\text{HS}} = \sqrt{q} \delta < \sqrt{2}.$$

Thus every eigenvalue $e^{i\theta}$ satisfies $|e^{i\theta} - 1| < \sqrt{2}$, so its principal angle obeys $|\theta| < \pi/2$. Centering is orthogonal projection onto the traceless Hermitian matrices and does not change spectral spread. Finally, $|\theta| \leq (\pi/2)|e^{i\theta} - 1|$ for $|\theta| \leq \pi/2$; summing its square over the eigenvalues proves the norm bound. $\square$

Theorem 6.7 (Cleaning-based global rounding). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer AME($2m, q$) state, $q = p^e$, $m \geq 2$, and $n = 2m$. Put

$$d_p = (2 - 2p^{-1/2})^{1/2},$$

and

$$R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} = \min \left\{ \frac{\tau_p}{8}, \frac{1}{4\sqrt{2q}}, \frac{1}{8\pi\sqrt{n}}, \frac{d_p}{1 + 4\pi\sqrt{n}} \right\}. \quad (6.3)$$

If $\varepsilon(U) < R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}}$, then, up to a global phase,

$$U = g \bigotimes_{i=1}^n e^{ih_i}, \quad g \in G(\psi),$$

where the h_i are traceless Hermitian, have spectral spread at most π , and satisfy

$$\left(\sum_i \|h_i\|_F^2 \right)^{1/2} \leq \pi\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U). \quad (6.4)$$

Before the exact-symmetry step, the recovered local Cliffords obey

$$q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|U_i - zK_i\|_{\text{HS}} \leq 8\varepsilon(U) \quad (6.5)$$

at every party. For fixed q , (6.3) has order $n^{-1/2}$, conditional on existence of the stated AME states.

Proof. Local Clifford frames. Choose party i as the logical leg and write the AME Choi form as $q^{-1/2} \sum_a |a\rangle \otimes V_i|a\rangle$. The other local factors form a transversal physical unitary T_i , and vectorization gives a logical unitary L_i , obtained from U_i by transpose and inverse, with $E(T_i, L_i) = \varepsilon(U)$. Lemmas 6.1 and 6.2, with $\eta = 8\varepsilon(U)$, give (6.5); transpose and inverse preserve the additive Clifford group.

Centered residual generators. Put $K = \bigotimes_i K_i$. For each i , choose a phase z_i attaining the minimum in (6.5), and let a_i be the principal Hermitian logarithm defined by

$$z_i^{-1} K_i^\dagger U_i = e^{ia_i}.$$

Set $\bar{a}_i = q^{-1} \text{Tr}(a_i)$ and $h_i = a_i - \bar{a}_i I$. Rephase K_i by $z_i e^{i\bar{a}_i}$; this changes $K = \bigotimes_i K_i$ only by a global phase and does not change its projective Clifford action. After this rephasing, $K_i^\dagger U_i = e^{ih_i}$, each h_i is traceless, centering does not increase its Frobenius norm, and its spectral spread is unchanged. By the second clause of (6.3), the bound (6.5) satisfies the hypothesis of Lemma 6.6; hence every spectral spread is at most π . Let $D^2 = \sum_i \|h_i\|_F^2$. The same lemma gives

$$D^2 \leq \frac{\pi^2 q}{4} \sum_i \left(q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|U_i - zK_i\|_{\text{HS}} \right)^2 \leq 16\pi^2 q n \varepsilon(U)^2. \quad (6.6)$$

The third clause of (6.3) gives $D \leq \sqrt{q}/2$.

Exact branch selection. Two-uniformity gives $\|(K^\dagger U - I)\psi\| \leq D/\sqrt{q} \leq 4\pi\sqrt{n}\varepsilon(U)$. The fourth clause and the triangle inequality put $K\psi$ less than d_p from ψ , so Lemma 6.3 makes K an exact symmetry. Apply Proposition 6.5 to obtain (6.4). $\square$

The theorem already contains a genuinely collective estimate once the exact branch has been selected. Writing $g = \bigotimes_i g_i$ in the factorization above,

$$\sum_i \left(q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|U_i - zg_i\|_{\text{HS}} \right)^2 \leq \frac{D^2}{q} \leq \pi^2 \varepsilon(U)^2. \quad (6.7)$$

The first inequality is the elementary chord bound $\|e^{ih_i} - I\|_{\text{HS}} \leq \|h_i\|_F$. Thus the $\sqrt{n}$ loss is absent after exact-symmetry recovery.

The same estimate applies to intertwiners between two states as soon as one exact intertwiner is fixed. This separates the cost of finding the correct orbit from stability within that orbit.

Corollary 6.8 (Relative intertwiner rounding). Let $|\psi\rangle, |\phi\rangle$ be stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ states as in Theorem 6.7, and suppose that $B = \bigotimes_i B_i$ is an exact product-unitary intertwiner from ψ to ϕ . For $U = \bigotimes_i U_i$, put

$$\varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U) = \min_{|z|=1} \|U\psi - z\phi\|.$$

If $\varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U) < \tau_p/8$, then each U_i is within normalized Hilbert–Schmidt distance $8\varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U)$ of $B_i K_i$ for a one-qudit Clifford K_i . If, in addition, $\varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U) < R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}}$, then, up to phase,

$$U = H \bigotimes_i e^{ih_i}, \quad H\psi \in \mathbb{C}\phi, \quad \left(\sum_i \|h_i\|_F^2 \right)^{1/2} \leq \pi \sqrt{q} \varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U),$$

where H is an exact product-unitary intertwiner and the h_i are traceless Hermitian of spectral spread at most π . After branch selection,

$$\sum_i \left(q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|U_i - zH_i\|_{\text{HS}} \right)^2 \leq \pi^2 \varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U)^2.$$

Thus the stability constants are independent of the party count; the certified radius remains $R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}}$.

Proof. Set $W = B^\dagger U = \bigotimes_i B_i^\dagger U_i$. Since $B\psi$ and ϕ span the same ray, $\varepsilon(W) = \varepsilon_{\psi \rightarrow \phi}(U)$. The first paragraph of the proof of Theorem 6.7 gives the local 8ε estimate under $\varepsilon(W) < \tau_p/8$. Under the stronger radius hypothesis, apply the theorem and (6.7) to W . If $W = g \bigotimes_i e^{ih_i}$ with $g \in G(\psi)$, then $H = Bg$ is an exact intertwiner from ψ to ϕ , and left multiplication by each B_i preserves normalized Hilbert–Schmidt distance. This proves all three estimates. Exact rigidity also makes every B_i Clifford, but that fact is not needed for the reduction. $\square$

This does not enlarge the entry radius in (6.3). Before the branch is known, cleaning supplies only the separate bounds (6.5) for locally chosen Cliffords K_i . The n encoded implementation errors are unitary reshaping of the same global defect vector, not projections onto orthogonal sectors, so their squared bounds cannot be summed by a Bessel argument. A radius-improving collective estimate would itself imply constant-radius branch selection: the chord–angle inequality would make $\sum_i \|h_i\|_F^2 = O(q\varepsilon^2)$, and the uniform stabilizer gap would force $\bigotimes_i K_i$ to be exact. The missing input is therefore compatibility of the recovered discrete Clifford data, not a sharper final norm summation.

The linear part of that compatibility can in fact be recovered without a party-count loss.

Proposition 6.9 (Robust compatibility of the transition maps). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state, $q = p^e$, and let $U = \bigotimes_i U_i$ be a product unitary. Suppose

$$\varepsilon(U) < R_q^{\text{trans}} := \min \left\{ \frac{\tau_p}{8}, \frac{2 \sin(\pi/p)}{4 + 64\sqrt{q}} \right\}.$$

The cleaning and Fourier lemmas give local Cliffords K_i satisfying (6.5). Let F_i be their symplectic maps. Then

$$F_j M_A(i, j) = M_A(i, j) F_i$$

for every $(m+1)$ -set A and $i, j \in A$. Consequently $F = \bigoplus_i F_i$ preserves the stabilizer label group L , and some product-Pauli correction $W_v K$ is an exact symmetry of ψ . For any prescribed m -party set, there is a unique such correction label v supported on that set.

Proof. Fix A , distinct $i, j \in A$, and put $B = A^c \cup \{i, j\}$. Both A and B have size $m+1$, while $A \cap B = \{i, j\}$. Choose $\ell \in L(A)$ and $r \in L(B)$. Using the stabilizer lifts $\widetilde{W}_\ell$ and $\widetilde{W}_r$ from (2.2), set

$$C = [U \widetilde{W}_\ell U^\dagger, \widetilde{W}_r] = [U W_\ell U^\dagger, W_r],$$

where the second equality holds because scalar lift phases cancel from a commutator. After choosing the phase of U realizing its defect, $\|(U \widetilde{W}_\ell U^\dagger - I)\psi\| \leq 2\varepsilon(U)$, and the same holds with the adjoint. Since $\widetilde{W}_r \psi = \psi$,

$$\|(C - I)\psi\| \leq 4\varepsilon(U). \quad (6.8)$$

The commutator is supported only on $A \cap B = \{i, j\}$. Choose phases so that $\|U_s - K_s\|_{\text{HS}} \leq 8\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U)$. Replacing $U_s W_{\ell_s} U_s^\dagger$ by its K_s -conjugate costs at most $16\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U)$ in operator norm, and replacing its commutator with W_{r_s} costs at most twice that. On the two sites, the total cost is therefore at most $64\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U)$. The Clifford commutator is a scalar p -th root ζ , so (6.8) gives

$$|\zeta - 1| \leq (4 + 64\sqrt{q})\varepsilon(U) < 2\sin(\pi/p).$$

Hence $\zeta = 1$.

Write $a = \ell_i$, $b = r_i$, $\ell_j = M_A(i, j)a$, and $r_j = M_B(i, j)b$. The identity $\zeta = 1$, for all a, b , says

$$[F_i a, b] + [F_j M_A(i, j)a, M_B(i, j)b] = 0. \quad (6.9)$$

Here brackets denote the trace-symplectic pairing. Isotropy of L , applied to the element of $L(A)$ whose i -coordinate is $F_i a$, gives

$$[F_i a, b] + [M_A(i, j)F_i a, M_B(i, j)b] = 0.$$

Subtracting this from (6.9), using surjectivity of $M_B(i, j)$ and nondegeneracy of the pairing, proves the transition equation. The exact transition-map theorem gives $FL = L$, and Lemma 4.2 supplies W_v . $\square$

The uncontrolled Pauli correction does not obstruct the logical action of a chosen encoder.

Corollary 6.10 (Logical Clifford rounding). Under the hypotheses and radius of Proposition 6.9, choose party i as the logical leg, and let L_i be the logical unitary induced by the other $2m-1$ factors as in the proof of Theorem 6.7. There is an exactly transversally realizable logical Clifford L'_i such that

$$q^{-1/2} \min_{|z|=1} \|L_i - zL'_i\|_{\text{HS}} \leq 8\varepsilon(U).$$

Proof. Write the exact symmetry supplied by the proposition as $W_v K$, where $K = \bigotimes_j K_j$. The projection of the stabilizer label group onto the Weyl plane at party i is surjective: this already holds for every minimum-support subgroup containing i . Multiply $W_v K$ by a stabilizer whose i -th label is $-v_i$. The result is still an exact product-Clifford symmetry, and its factor at i is projectively K_i . The Choi correspondence therefore makes its other factors an exact transversal implementation of $L'_i = (K_i^\top)^{-1}$. The logical unitary L_i is the same transpose-inverse transform of U_i , up to phase, so (6.5) proves the displayed bound. $\square$

The Pauli correction in the proposition is essential. All localized commutators are unchanged when a recovered K_i is multiplied by a local Weyl: that multiplication changes conjugation phases, and the commutator cancels them. Equivalently, the transition maps see L but not its stabilizer character. The correction v can therefore be nonzero modulo L , in which case $W_v K$ need not be locally close to U . Its unique half-supported normal form localizes the ambiguity but does not bound its distance from the identity. Exact affine compatibility cannot be obtained from these commutator tests, and Proposition 6.9 alone does not improve (6.3). Controlling the character discrepancy is the same remaining branch-selection problem isolated by the collective estimate above.

The exact formula, rather than a fixed-dimension slogan, controls scaling. Uniformly over prime powers $q = p^e$ and existing tensors,

$$R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} = \Theta\left(\min\{p^{-1}, q^{-1/2}, n^{-1/2}\}\right), \quad (6.10)$$

with absolute implied constants. Indeed $\sin(\pi/p) = \Theta(p^{-1})$, while d_p is bounded above and below by positive absolute constants. An asymptotic use of (6.10) must specify an existing family.

For the explicit generalized and extended generalized Reed–Solomon construction [SR86], together with the standard MDS-to-AME construction [RGRA18], $n = 2m \leq q + 1$, so the party-count term cannot be smaller than the local-dimension term. Hence

$$R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} = \begin{cases} \Theta(q^{-1}), & q = p, \\ \Theta(q^{-1/2}), & q = p^e, e \geq 2. \end{cases} \quad (6.11)$$

On a length-saturating subfamily $n \asymp q$, these are $\Theta(n^{-1})$ and $\Theta(n^{-1/2})$, respectively. For fixed characteristic and growing extension degree, the second line applies. The earlier fixed- q , $n^{-1/2}$ reading of the exact minimum remains a conditional formal slice only; it is not an AME-existence claim.

If the sharper local constant and the old global generator budget are needed, the same proof gives the conclusion of Corollary B.16 under

$$\varepsilon(U) < \min\left\{\frac{\tau_p}{8}, \frac{1}{16\pi n\sqrt{q}}\right\}. \quad (6.12)$$

Indeed (6.5), the operator-norm bound by Hilbert–Schmidt norm, and the principal logarithm give $\sum_i \|h_i\|_{\text{op}} \leq 8\pi n\sqrt{q}\varepsilon(U) < 1/2$; the sharp local theorem then gives $D \leq \sqrt{6q/5}\varepsilon(U)$.

The cleaning radius is the governing bound; (6.12) is useful only when its sharper local constant and global generator budget are needed. The $n^{-1/2}$ scale is a proved lower bound, not an optimality claim; no product-unitary family is known to saturate the collective frame-error estimate (6.6).

7 Conclusion

The same support geometry controls the exact and approximate problems. On an $(m+1)$ -party marginal it exposes every local Weyl axis, which turns arbitrary product-unitary intertwiners into product Cliffords. The transition maps between the resulting local Weyl frames organize the residual freedom. After one party is reinterpreted as a logical input, the support geometry becomes three-region correctability. Cleaning and Weyl–Fourier concentration then recover the same discrete Clifford frame without paying the exponentially small amplitude of a single marginal.

The exact classification is finite and constructive. A half-set direct sum reduces the data to the dimensionally optimal m minimum supports and gives fixed-label recognition in polynomial time for fixed local dimension. Over prime fields, the common centralizer of the fundamental cycles is the intrinsic algebra of block-diagonal one-party label endomorphisms preserving the stabilizer. Its five possible types determine both the symmetry group and the additional code structure. For four and six parties this algebra is necessarily nonscalar. The same recognition procedure decides transversal conversion between the associated encoders.

The quantitative conclusion is uniform only when all varying parameters are displayed:

$$R_{n,q}^{\text{clean}} = \Theta\left(\min\{p^{-1}, q^{-1/2}, n^{-1/2}\}\right), \quad q = p^e.$$

For fixed local dimension this gives the conditional $n^{-1/2}$ scale along any existing stabilizer-AME family. On generalized and extended Reed–Solomon constructions, where $n \leq q + 1$, the scale is $\Theta(q^{-1})$ over prime fields and $\Theta(q^{-1/2})$ when $e \geq 2$. These are certified radii; their optimal order is open.

The robust transition-map result identifies the remaining bottleneck. Linear symplectic compatibility becomes exact at a radius depending only on the local dimension, but commutators discard the affine Weyl phases. They therefore determine the stabilizer label group and not its character. The logical action of any chosen encoder can nevertheless be rounded within 8ε to an exactly transversally realizable Clifford, because a stabilizer cancels the Pauli correction on the logical leg. A party-count-independent global entry theorem would need a new way to control that character discrepancy, or an equivalent collective branch selection principle, before the product-Pauli correction is known to be locally small.

A Module structures from the endomorphism algebra

This appendix proves the last column of Table 1. It is not needed for LU rigidity, recognition, or robust rounding. Throughout, $m \geq 2$, $q = p$, and $E = \mathcal{E}_L$.

For every half-set S , projection $L \rightarrow \bigoplus_{i \in S} P_i$ is an E -linear isomorphism. Hence the E -module L is the direct sum of m copies of the local module.

If $E \cong \mathbb{F}_q \times \mathbb{F}_q$, its primitive idempotents split every local plane into two lines and split $L = L_X \oplus L_Z$. Half-set bijectivity restricts to each summand, so L_X and L_Z are classical $[2m, m, m+1]_q$ MDS codes. After compatible local symplectic bases are chosen, the ambient alternating form pairs the two axis systems; isotropy and dimension identify the codes as weighted duals. This gives an MDS–CSS stabilizer after local symplectic coordinate changes.

If $E \cong \mathbb{F}_{q^2}$, every local plane is its one-dimensional regular module. Thus $L \cong E^m$, and the half-set isomorphisms make it an E -linear $[2m, m, m+1]_{q^2}$ MDS code. In compatible local E -coordinates, every nondegenerate alternating $\mathbb{F}_q$ -form on E has the form

$$(x, y) \longmapsto \text{Tr}_{E/\mathbb{F}_q}(\kappa_i x y^q), \quad \kappa_i^q = -\kappa_i \neq 0. \quad (\text{A.1})$$

Applying isotropy to ax, y for all $a \in E$, then using the nondegenerate trace pairing, gives

$$\sum_i \kappa_i x_i y_i^q = 0 \quad (x, y \in L).$$

The trace-zero elements form a one-dimensional $\mathbb{F}_q$ -space. After one nonzero trace-zero κ is fixed, write $\kappa_i = w_i \kappa$ with $w_i \in \mathbb{F}_q^\times$. The displayed relation then becomes $\sum_i w_i x_i y_i^q = 0$ after division by κ , which is weighted Hermitian self-duality. The argument includes characteristic two.

If $E \cong \mathbb{F}_q[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^2)$, a faithful two-dimensional $\mathbb{F}_q$ -module has a nonzero square-zero action and is therefore the regular rank-one module. Hence L is free of rank m over E , and every

half-set projection is an isomorphism of free modules. No distance or self-duality convention over the ring is used.

Finally, if $E = M_2(\mathbb{F}_q)$, align the local actions by local module coordinates. The unique simple module is $\mathbb{F}_q^2$, and semisimplicity gives

$$L = \mathbb{F}_q^2 \otimes C$$

for a multiplicity space $C \subseteq \mathbb{F}_q^{2m}$. Dimension and half-set bijectivity make C a classical $[2m, m, m+1]_q$ MDS code. Each local alternating form is $w_i J$ in these coordinates, with $w_i \neq 0$, and isotropy becomes

$$\sum_i w_i c_i d_i = 0 \quad (c, d \in C).$$

Thus C is self-dual for the weighted coordinate pairing, giving the maximally symmetric MDS–CSS row after local symplectic coordinate changes.

B Secondary quantitative routes and local stability

This appendix derives discreteness and local quadratic stability from two-uniformity alone, without the stabilizer hypothesis used by the main cleaning argument. It then shows how higher uniformity enlarges the certified generator-coordinate region and strengthens the residual estimate proved directly in Section 6. Readers interested only in the headline exact and quantitative theorems may skip these comparisons.

B.1 Discreteness from two-party maximal mixing

The rigidity theorem uses the stabilizer hypothesis to identify the symmetry group. Finiteness of that group needs far less: two-party marginals alone, at any local dimension, with no stabilizer structure. Throughout this subsection $q \geq 2$ is an arbitrary integer; only the statements naming Clifford operators return to $q = p^e$.

Call a pure state $|\psi\rangle \in (\mathbb{C}^q)^{\otimes n}$ *2-uniform* if

$$\rho_{\{j,k\}}^\psi = q^{-2}I \quad \text{for all } j \neq k.$$

Tracing once more makes every one-party marginal $q^{-1}I$. Such states exist only for $n \geq 4$, since at $n = 3$ purity forces $\text{rank } \rho_{\{1,2\}} = \text{rank } \rho_{\{3\}} \leq q$; and every $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state with $m \geq 2$ is 2-uniform, stabilizer or not. Write

$$G(\psi) = \{U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_n : (U_1 \otimes \cdots \otimes U_n)|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{C}|\psi\rangle\}$$

for its product-unitary symmetry group and, for a product unitary U ,

$$\varepsilon(U) = \min_{\theta} \|U|\psi\rangle - e^{i\theta}|\psi\rangle\| = (2 - 2|\langle\psi|U|\psi\rangle|)^{1/2}$$

for its defect. Because operators on distinct sites commute, a product unitary is a single exponential: $\bigotimes_j e^{iH_j} = e^{iL}$ with $L = \sum_j H_j^{(j)}$, where $H^{(j)}$ denotes H acting at site j . Splitting each H_j into a traceless part h_j and a multiple of the identity leaves $L = M + cI$ with $M = \sum_j h_j^{(j)}$. Everything below rests on one computation about M .

Figure 3 gives a roadmap for the local estimates, the Clifford separation step, and the resulting explicit threshold.

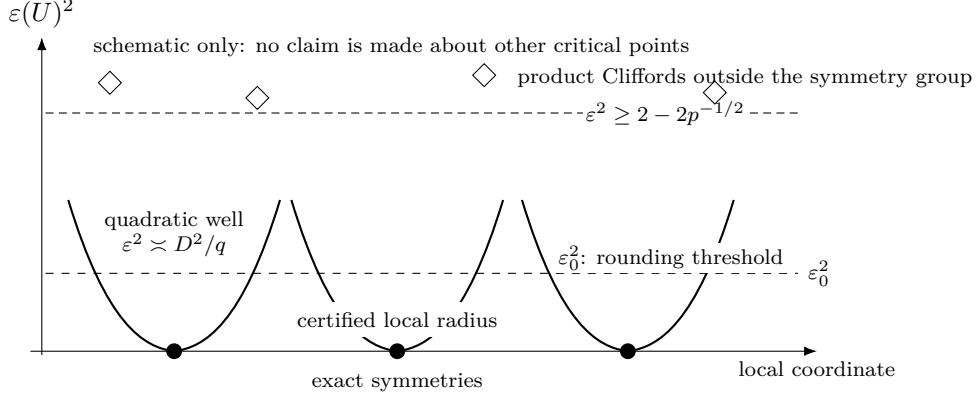


Figure 3: Roadmap for the defect estimates (a one-dimensional schematic of a high-dimensional product-unitary group). Exact symmetries are isolated zeros with certified local quadratic growth. Every product Clifford outside the symmetry group has defect at least $(2 - 2p^{-1/2})^{1/2}$; below the explicit cleaning threshold of Section 6, an arbitrary product unitary rounds to a Clifford and then to an exact symmetry. The picture asserts neither that every local minimum is Clifford nor that the displayed coordinate exhausts the group.

Lemma B.1 (Local-generator isometry). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be 2-uniform and let h_j and h'_j , $1 \leq j \leq n$, be traceless Hermitian operators on $\mathbb{C}^q$. Put $M = \sum_j h_j^{(j)}$ and $M' = \sum_j h'_j^{(j)}$. Then $\langle \psi | M | \psi \rangle = 0$ and

$$\langle M | \psi \rangle, M' | \psi \rangle \rangle = \frac{1}{q} \sum_{j=1}^n \text{Tr}(h_j h'_j). \quad (\text{B.1})$$

In particular $\|M | \psi \rangle\|^2 = q^{-1} \sum_j \|h_j\|_F^2$, so $(h_1, \dots, h_n) \mapsto \sqrt{q} M | \psi \rangle$ is an isometry from the traceless local generators, carrying the product Frobenius form, into the Hilbert space regarded as a real inner product space.

Proof. One-party maximal mixing gives $\langle M \rangle = 0$. In the expansion of $\langle M M' \rangle$, equal-site terms are $\text{Tr}(h_j h'_j)/q$, while distinct-site terms are $\text{Tr}(h_j) \text{Tr}(h'_k)/q^2 = 0$. Thus the displayed inner product has the stated real part. Its imaginary part is $\langle [M, M'] \rangle / 2i = 0$, because only traceless one-site commutators remain. $\square$

Pairwise maximal mixing is essential: for a Bell pair, $M = h \otimes I - I \otimes h^T$ annihilates the state, producing the familiar $U \otimes \bar{U}$ continuous symmetry.

We also need the standard Lie-algebra form of a product-unitary generator.

Lemma B.2 (Product generators). Let $\pi : U(q)^n \rightarrow U(q^n)$ send $(U_1, \dots, U_n)$ to $U_1 \otimes \dots \otimes U_n$. Then π is a smooth homomorphism of compact Lie groups, its image P is closed, and

$$\text{Lie}(P) = \left\{ i \sum_j H_j^{(j)} : H_j = H_j^\dagger \text{ on } \mathbb{C}^q \right\}. \quad (\text{B.2})$$

Thus every one-parameter subgroup of a closed subgroup of P has such a generator.

Proof. The source is compact, so P is closed. At the identity,

$$d\pi(iH_1, \dots, iH_n) = i \sum_j H_j^{(j)}.$$

Surjectivity onto P makes this map onto $\text{Lie}(P)$. The final claim is the closed-subgroup theorem. $\square$

Theorem B.3 (Discreteness from 2-uniformity). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a 2-uniform pure state of n qudits of local dimension q . Then $\text{Lie}(G(\psi)) = i\mathbb{R}I$, and $G(\psi)/U(1) \cdot I$ is finite. In particular every $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state with $m \geq 2$, stabilizer or not, has finite product-unitary symmetry group modulo global phase.

Proof. The set $\{U \in U(q^n) : U|\psi\rangle \in \mathbb{C}|\psi\rangle\}$ is a closed subgroup, so $G(\psi) = P \cap \{\dots\}$ is a closed subgroup of P and hence a compact Lie group. Let $X \in \text{Lie}(G(\psi))$. By Lemma B.2, $X = iL$ with $L = \sum_j H_j^{(j)}$ Hermitian; write $L = M + cI$ as above. Each e^{itL} fixes the ray of $|\psi\rangle$, so $e^{itL}|\psi\rangle = \lambda(t)|\psi\rangle$ with $\lambda(t) = \langle\psi|e^{itL}|\psi\rangle$ unimodular and smooth in t . Differentiating at $t = 0$ shows that $|\psi\rangle$ is an eigenvector of the Hermitian operator L , say $L|\psi\rangle = \mu|\psi\rangle$ with μ real. Pairing with $|\psi\rangle$ and using $\langle M \rangle = 0$ gives $\mu = c$, hence $M|\psi\rangle = 0$. By Lemma B.1, $\sum_j \|h_j\|_F^2 = 0$, so every $h_j = 0$ and every H_j is scalar. Thus $\text{Lie}(G(\psi)) = i\mathbb{R}I$. Since $U(1) \cdot I$ is a closed central one-dimensional subgroup of $G(\psi)$, the compact Lie group $G(\psi)/U(1) \cdot I$ has dimension zero and is therefore finite. $\square$

Remark B.4 (Which torus is divided out). Upstairs in $U(q)^n$ the preimage $\pi^{-1}(G(\psi))$ always contains the local-phase torus $T = U(1)^n$, of dimension n . This does not contradict the theorem: $\pi(T) = U(1) \cdot I$ and $\ker \pi \subset T$ has dimension $n-1$, so $\pi^{-1}(G(\psi))/T \cong G(\psi)/U(1) \cdot I$. Statements about local factors below are statements on $\text{PU}(q)^n$, not statements modulo one global phase.

Remark B.5 (Discreteness in the literature). Wirthmüller proves related finiteness criteria for binary stabilizer codes [Wir11, Theorem 7 and Corollary 11]; qubit stabilizer symmetries are classified in [EK20], and Tan computes the four-qutrit AME group [Tan26b, Theorem 5.3]. The theorem above instead uses only 2-uniformity and allows arbitrary local dimension and nonstabilizer states.

The hypothesis cannot be reduced to one-party maximal mixing: such states can have positive-dimensional local-unitary symmetry [SSM21, Lemma 2]. Thus pairwise maximal mixing, not merely criticality of the state, is what eliminates continuous product symmetries.

Remark B.6 (Two-uniformity does not identify the group). The equal-phase CSS state of $C = \text{RM}(1, 4) \leq \mathbb{F}_2^{16}$ is 2-uniform because $d(C) = 8$ and $d(C^\perp) = 4$. Yet $T^{\otimes 16}$, $T = \text{diag}(1, e^{i\pi/4})$, fixes it: all codeword weights are 0, 8, or 16. Since T does not preserve Weyl axes, two-uniformity forces finiteness but not Cliffordness. The AME hypothesis and Theorem 1.1 supply that second conclusion.

Corollary B.7 (Discrete product-unitary symmetry). For a stabilizer AME state as in Theorem 1.1, let $G \leq U(q)^{2m}$ be its local-factor tuple group and let $\tilde{G} \leq U(q)^{2m} \rtimes S_{2m}$ also allow party permutations. The coordinatewise scalar torus $T = (S^1)^{2m}$ is the identity component of both groups, and $\Gamma = G/T$ and $\tilde{\Gamma} = \tilde{G}/T$ are finite discrete groups. If Π is the realized party-permutation group, then

$$1 \longrightarrow \Gamma \longrightarrow \tilde{\Gamma} \longrightarrow \Pi \longrightarrow 1.$$

This extension splits exactly when the realized permutations admit a homomorphic choice of projective product-unitary lifts.

Proof. Theorem 1.1 puts every local factor in the finite projective Clifford group. Projectivization has kernel T , so its image is finite and discrete and T is the identity component. Retaining the party permutation defines the quotient map $\tilde{\Gamma} \rightarrow \Pi$; its kernel is Γ , giving the displayed sequence. Its splitting criterion is the definition of a split extension. $\square$

B.2 Local quadratic stability

Discreteness makes the exact symmetries isolated. The same identity (B.1) says how fast the defect grows away from them, with a constant that does not involve the number of parties.

Theorem B.8 (Local stability). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be 2-uniform, let each h_j be traceless Hermitian on $\mathbb{C}^q$, and put

$$U = \bigotimes_{j=1}^n e^{ih_j}, \quad t = \sum_{j=1}^n \|h_j\|_{\text{op}}, \quad D = \left(\sum_{j=1}^n \|h_j\|_F^2 \right)^{1/2}.$$

If $t \leq \frac{1}{2}$ then

$$\frac{D^2}{q} \left(1 - \frac{t}{3} \right) \leq \varepsilon(U)^2 \leq \frac{D^2}{q} \left(1 + \frac{t}{3} \right). \quad (\text{B.3})$$

In particular $D \leq \sqrt{6q/5} \varepsilon(U) < 1.096\sqrt{q} \varepsilon(U)$, and $\varepsilon(U)^2/D^2 \rightarrow q^{-1}$ as $t \rightarrow 0$, uniformly in n .

Proof. Since the sites commute, $U = e^{iM}$ with $\|M\|_{\text{op}} \leq t$. Put $\mu_2 = \langle M^2 \rangle = D^2/q$, using Lemma B.1. Taylor's theorem and the spectral calculus give

$$\langle e^{iM} \rangle = 1 - \mu_2/2 + r, \quad |r| \leq t\mu_2/6.$$

Since $\mu_2 \leq t^2 \leq 1/4$, the real main term is positive, and

$$\left| |\langle e^{iM} \rangle| - (1 - \mu_2/2) \right| \leq t\mu_2/6.$$

Substitution into $\varepsilon(U)^2 = 2 - 2|\langle e^{iM} \rangle|$ proves (B.3) and its stated consequences. $\square$

The constant $\sqrt{6/5} = 1.0954\dots$ is therefore sharp to within about ten percent: the true asymptotic constant is $\sqrt{q}$, and the excess is the cubic Taylor cutoff, not structure.

Remark B.9 (The stability constant is a Fisher metric). For $U(s) = e^{isM}$, the pure-state quantum Fisher information is $4 \text{Var}_\psi(M)$ [BC94]. Hence (B.1) gives

$$F_Q = \frac{4}{q} \sum_{j=1}^n \|h_j\|_F^2.$$

Thus 2-uniformity makes the Fisher form a flat multiple of the Euclidean form on traceless one-site generators. This determines the local constant, but the size of the certified neighbourhood depends on higher moments and is treated next.

B.3 Higher uniformity and the generator-coordinate region

The size of the certified region is controlled by the state's uniformity order, not by the number of parties. Call $|\psi\rangle$ *k-uniform* if every reduced operator on at most k parties is maximally mixed; 2-uniformity is the case $k = 2$, and an $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state is m -uniform. The hypothesis $t \leq \frac{1}{2}$ in Theorem B.8 pays for a cubic Taylor remainder. Each additional order of uniformity removes one order from that remainder, because the state and the tracial state assign the same value to every power of M below the uniformity order.

Lemma B.10 (Tracial agreement below the uniformity order). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be k -uniform on n qudits. Then $\langle \psi | O | \psi \rangle = q^{-n} \text{Tr } O$ for every operator O supported on at most k parties. In particular, with $M = \sum_j h_j^{(j)}$ as above, $\langle \psi | M^r | \psi \rangle = q^{-n} \text{Tr}(M^r)$ for every $r \leq k$.

Proof. If $O = O_S \otimes I$ with $|S| \leq k$ then $\langle O \rangle = \text{Tr}(\rho_S^\psi O_S) = q^{-|S|} \text{Tr} O_S = q^{-n} \text{Tr} O$. Expanding M^r gives a sum of products of one-site operators touching at most $r \leq k$ sites, so every term is of that shape. $\square$

The tracial state $q^{-n} \text{Tr}$ is the product of the one-site tracial states, and the site summands of M commute, so $q^{-n} \text{Tr} f(M) = \mathbb{E} f(X_1 + \dots + X_n)$ with the X_j independent and X_j uniform on the spectrum of h_j . The tracial main term is therefore a product of one-site characteristic functions, and the following contraction estimate controls each factor.

Lemma B.11 (Per-site contraction). Let h be traceless Hermitian on $\mathbb{C}^q$ with spectral spread $s = \lambda_{\max}(h) - \lambda_{\min}(h)$. Then

$$|q^{-1} \text{Tr} e^{ih}|^2 \leq 1 - c(s) \|h\|_F^2 / q, \quad c(s) = \max \left\{ 1 - \frac{s^2}{12}, \frac{4}{\pi^2} [s \leq \pi] \right\}.$$

Proof. Write $q^{-1} \text{Tr} e^{ih} = \mathbb{E} e^{iX}$ with X uniform on the spectrum. For an independent copy X' , $|\mathbb{E} e^{iX}|^2 = \mathbb{E} \cos(X - X')$ and $|X - X'| \leq s$. From $\cos u \leq 1 - u^2/2 + u^4/24 = 1 - (u^2/2)(1 - u^2/12)$ and $u^2 \leq s^2$, $\mathbb{E} \cos(X - X') \leq 1 - (1 - s^2/12) \text{Var} X$; from $\cos u \leq 1 - 2u^2/\pi^2$ for $|u| \leq \pi$, $\mathbb{E} \cos(X - X') \leq 1 - (4/\pi^2) \text{Var} X$. Tracelessness gives $\text{Var} X = \text{Tr}(h^2)/q = \|h\|_F^2/q$. $\square$

Theorem B.12 (Stability at uniformity order k). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be k -uniform with $k \geq 2$, let each h_j be traceless Hermitian with spectral spread at most s , and keep t, D, U as in Theorem B.8. Put

$$c = c(s), \quad \lambda = \frac{2t^{k-1}}{(k+1)!}, \quad \rho = c - \frac{c^2 D^2}{4q} - 2\lambda.$$

Then $\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq \rho D^2/q$; in particular $\rho > 0$ gives $D \leq \sqrt{q/\rho} \varepsilon(U)$.

Proof. Write $e^{ix} = \sum_{r \leq k} (ix)^r / r! + \varrho(x)$ with $|\varrho(x)| \leq |x|^{k+1}/(k+1)!$. By Lemma B.10 the state and the tracial state agree on every M^r with $r \leq k$, so $\langle e^{iM} \rangle - q^{-n} \text{Tr} e^{iM} = \langle \varrho(M) \rangle - q^{-n} \text{Tr} \varrho(M)$. For any spectral weight vector $p_i \geq 0$ with $\sum_i p_i = 1$,

$$\left| \sum_i p_i \varrho(\lambda_i) \right| \leq \frac{\|M\|_{\text{op}}^{k-1}}{(k+1)!} \sum_i p_i \lambda_i^2,$$

and both states give M^2 the value D^2/q , by Lemma B.10 with $r = 2$ on one side and by tracelessness on the other. Since $\|M\|_{\text{op}} \leq t$, each term is at most $t^{k-1} D^2/(q(k+1)!)$, so the two expectations differ by at most $\lambda D^2/q$. The sites commute, so $q^{-n} \text{Tr} e^{iM} = \prod_j q^{-1} \text{Tr} e^{ih_j}$, and Lemma B.11 with $1 - y \leq e^{-y}$ gives

$$|\langle e^{iM} \rangle| \leq \prod_j (1 - c \|h_j\|_F^2 / q)^{1/2} + \lambda D^2/q \leq e^{-c D^2/(2q)} + \lambda D^2/q.$$

With $x = c D^2/(2q)$ and $1 - e^{-x} \geq x - x^2/2$, $\varepsilon(U)^2 = 2 - 2|\langle e^{iM} \rangle| \geq 2x - x^2 - 2\lambda D^2/q = \rho D^2/q$. $\square$

Corollary B.13 (The certified radius grows with the uniformity order). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be k -uniform with $k \geq 2$. If every h_j has spectral spread at most $\frac{1}{2}$, if $D \leq \sqrt{q}/2$, and if

$$t \leq R_k := \left(\frac{(k+1)!}{48} \right)^{1/(k-1)},$$

then $D \leq \sqrt{6q/5} \varepsilon(U)$. One has $\log R_k = \log k - 1 + O(\log k/k)$, so $R_k \sim k/e$.

Proof. Spread at most $\frac{1}{2}$ gives $c \geq 1 - \frac{1}{48} = 0.97917$; with $D^2 \leq q/4$, $c^2 D^2/(4q) \leq c^2/16$, so $c - c^2 D^2/(4q) \geq 0.91924$; and $t^{k-1} \leq (k+1)!/48$ gives $2\lambda \leq \frac{1}{12}$. Hence $\rho \geq 0.83591 > \frac{5}{6}$ and $\sqrt{q/\rho} \leq \sqrt{6q/5}$. The asymptotics are Stirling's formula applied to $\log R_k = (\log(k+1)! - \log 48)/(k-1)$. $\square$

At $k = 2$ the direct theorem is stronger; for an AME($2m, q$) state, $k = m$ and $R_k \sim k/e$, so the certified generator radius grows linearly in the party count. The following scalar example shows that no uniform estimate of this form can grow faster.

Proposition B.14 (Ceiling on the certified radius). For every $q \geq 2$ and every n there are traceless Hermitian h_j on $\mathbb{C}^q$ with $\sum_j \|h_j\|_{\text{op}} = 2\pi(1 - 1/q)n$ and $D > 0$ for which $\bigotimes_j e^{ih_j}$ is a scalar, hence $\varepsilon = 0$. No estimate $\varepsilon(U)^2 \geq \rho D^2/q$ with $\rho > 0$ can therefore hold on a region of radius exceeding $2\pi(1 - 1/q)n$.

Proof. Take $h_j = (2\pi/q) \text{diag}(q-1, -1, \dots, -1)$ at every site. It is traceless, and both eigenvalues of e^{ih_j} equal $e^{-2\pi i/q}$, so $e^{ih_j} = e^{-2\pi i/q} I$ and the product of n of them is a global phase. Here $\|h_j\|_{\text{op}} = 2\pi(q-1)/q$ and $\|h_j\|_F^2 = (2\pi/q)^2 q(q-1) > 0$. $\square$

Thus linear growth is the maximal possible order. At fixed uniformity order the next family gives a length-independent obstruction.

Proposition B.15 (The certified radius at uniformity order three). Let $\ell \geq 3$, $N = 2^\ell$, and let $|C\rangle$ be the equal-phase CSS state of $C = \text{RM}(1, \ell) \leq \mathbb{F}_2^N$. Its uniformity order is 3, for every ℓ . Take $h_j = cZ(1)$ at every site and put $\theta = Nc \in (0, 2\pi)$. Then

$$\sum_j \|h_j\|_{\text{op}} = \theta, \quad D = \frac{\theta\sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{N}}, \quad \varepsilon = \frac{2|\sin(\theta/2)|}{\sqrt{N}}, \quad \frac{D}{\sqrt{2}\varepsilon} = \frac{\theta}{2\sin(\theta/2)}.$$

The last ratio does not depend on N and increases on $(0, 2\pi)$; it passes $\sqrt{6/5}$ at the unique $\theta^* = 1.46562\dots$. Hence the conclusion of Theorem B.8 fails for every $t > \theta^*$, for every length. At uniformity order three the supremal radius for the constant $\sqrt{6q/5}$ therefore lies between $R_3 = 1/\sqrt{2}$ and θ^* .

Proof. The nonzero weights of $\text{RM}(1, \ell)$ are $N/2$ and N , and $C^\perp = \text{RM}(\ell-2, \ell)$ has minimum distance 4. A marginal of the equal-phase CSS state fails to be maximally mixed only when a nonzero word of C or of $C^\perp$ is supported inside it, so by (2.3) the uniformity order is $\min(N/2, 4) - 1 = 3$ whenever $N \geq 8$. Since $Z(1)|x\rangle = (-1)^x|x\rangle$ at a single site, $U|x\rangle = e^{ic(N-2\text{wt}(x))}|x\rangle$, and the weight distribution 1, $2N-2$, 1 on weights 0, $N/2$, N gives $\langle U \rangle = 1 - (1 - \cos \theta)/N$. This is nonnegative, so $\varepsilon^2 = 2 - 2\langle U \rangle = 4\sin^2(\theta/2)/N$. Also $\|cZ(1)\|_F^2 = 2c^2$ and $\|cZ(1)\|_{\text{op}} = c$, giving the displayed D and θ . Finally $\theta/(2\sin(\theta/2)) = u/\sin u$ with $u = \theta/2 \in (0, \pi)$, which increases from 1 to ∞ ; for every $\theta > \theta^*$ the ratio exceeds the constant of Theorem B.8. The violation begins at the limiting defect $2\sin(\theta^*/2)N^{-1/2}$. $\square$

The example fixes the relevant parameter: the obstruction remains at uniformity order three as N grows, whereas an AME($2m, q$) state has order m . These are generator-coordinate estimates for known product unitaries, not certification statements for an unknown device.

Comparison with the balanced-cut estimate. Proposition 6.5 removes the global ℓ^1 budget, permits per-site spectral spread up to π , and gives

$$D \leq 2\sqrt{q/c(s)} \varepsilon(U), \quad c(s) = \max \left\{ 1 - \frac{s^2}{12}, \frac{4}{\pi^2} \right\}.$$

It is complementary to the moment estimate above and is proved in the main text.

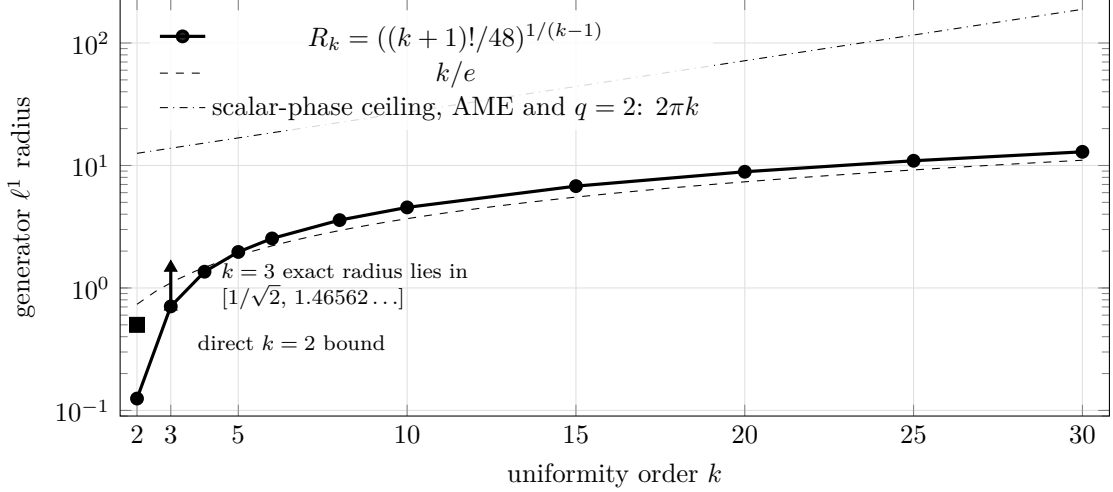


Figure 4: Certified generator ℓ^1 radius of the quadratic stability estimate against uniformity order. The general radius $R_k = ((k+1)!/48)^{1/(k-1)}$ grows as k/e ; scalar-phase configurations bound every such radius by $2\pi(1 - 1/q)n$, so linear growth is the maximal order. For an $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state, $k = m$. At $k = 3$, the Reed–Muller family pins the exact radius for the constant $\sqrt{6q/5}$ inside the displayed interval.

B.4 From local stability to exact branch selection

Corollary B.16 (Approximate symmetries decompose). Let $|\psi\rangle$ be a stabilizer $\text{AME}(2m, q)$ state with $m \geq 2$. There is an $\varepsilon_0(\psi) > 0$ such that every product unitary U with $\varepsilon(U) < \varepsilon_0$ factors as

$$U = g \cdot \bigotimes_{j=1}^{2m} e^{ih_j}, \quad g \in G(\psi),$$

with the h_j traceless Hermitian, $\sum_j \|h_j\|_{\text{op}} \leq \frac{1}{2}$, and

$$\left(\sum_j \|h_j\|_F^2 \right)^{1/2} \leq \sqrt{6q/5} \varepsilon(U).$$

By Theorem 1.1 the factor g is an exact local-Clifford symmetry.

The size constraint on the h_j is part of the conclusion and cannot be dropped: the generators of Proposition B.14 are traceless with $\bigotimes_j e^{ih_j}$ scalar, so the defect vanishes while the generator norm does not.

Proof. On $X = \text{PU}(q)^{2m}$, put $f(U) = \varepsilon(U)^2$. Let $B \subseteq X$ be the image of $\{(h_j) \text{ traceless} : \sum_j \|h_j\|_{\text{op}} < \frac{1}{2}\}$ under $(h_j) \mapsto [\bigotimes_j e^{ih_j}]$. On this principal-logarithm neighbourhood the map is a diffeomorphism, so B is open. Theorem B.8 gives

$$f \geq \frac{5}{6q} \sum_j \|h_j\|_F^2$$

there. Since $f(gV) = f(V)$ for every exact symmetry g , the same estimate holds on every translate gB .

The zero set Z of f is finite by Theorem B.3 and Remark B.4. So $\bigcup_{g \in Z} gB$ is a neighbourhood of Z . On its compact complement K , either $K = \emptyset$ or $\min_K f > 0$. In the first case the factorization holds for every U , so choose any $\varepsilon_0 > 0$. Taking $\varepsilon_0^2 < \min_K f$ in the latter case forces $U \in gB$ for some $g \in Z$, and the translated quadratic estimate gives the conclusion. $\square$

The factorization holds for every 2-uniform state; the stabilizer hypothesis identifies g as Clifford. Its compactness threshold is not explicit. Section 6 supplies an explicit cleaning radius, and Corollary 6.8 transfers it without loss when an exact base intertwiner is known.

The same conclusion has the standard gate-theoretic interpretation. If a two-qudit gate W reshapes to an $\text{AME}(4, q)$ state, then reshaping identifies its local equivalence group with the product-unitary symmetry group of that state: an action on the two input legs becomes complex conjugation on the corresponding state factors. Theorem B.3 and Remark B.4 therefore make the local equivalence group finite modulo one-site phases. For gates arising from stabilizer $\text{AME}(4, q)$ states it is locally Clifford, by Theorem 1.1. This is the usual two-unitary correspondence; see [RAL22, Pah26].

C Verification and trust boundary

The principal results are conceptual proofs. This paper contains no paper-facing finite census, generated certificate, or numerical experiment. Its trust boundary has three layers: complete manuscript proofs, selected kernel-checked algebraic cores, and standard results imported by citation.

The formal source namespace is `RelativeConicArcs.AMELU`. In the checked Lean toolchain `v4.32.0-rc1`, the relevant exact cores lie in the support-profile, tensor-rigidity, holonomy-centralizer, stabilizer-dictionary, encoder-transversal, and multipartite modules. The dedicated `AMELUTwoUniformRigidity` gate now audits twenty-two quantitative-core declarations, including the exact-base relative reduction, with only `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`. The pre-split aggregate spans a wider development than this paper: it also carries the six-party MDS–CSS applications that appear in the companion paper [Rudd26], so it is not a closure specific to the results here, and no content-addressed contract identifies a subset of it as this paper’s own. Each row of Table 2 therefore states which algebraic core is kernel checked, and the paper claims no end-to-end formalization of any theorem family.

The cleaning theorem uses three cited exact inputs: stabilizer cleaning, localization of nested commutators, and the exact three-cleanable-region Clifford obstruction. The manuscript proves the leakage estimate, the finite Weyl–Fourier concentration step, the stabilizer overlap gap, and their AME composition. Its closed-form deductions do not depend on a computational search or floating-point evaluation.

The quantitative appendix serves as a mechanism comparison. None of its results is used to prove Theorem 1.3.

AI assistance disclosure

This project was developed with extensive assistance from OpenAI Codex and Anthropic Claude. Under the author’s direction, the systems assisted throughout with proof exploration, literature research, symbolic and finite computation, code and formal-proof development, verification, and manuscript drafting and revision. The author checked the resulting arguments, computations, code, and cited sources, reviewed and edited all AI-assisted material, and assumes responsibility for all content.

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Table 2: Trust boundary for the theorem families retained in this paper. “Core formalization” means that the named algebraic step is kernel checked; it does not promote the complete manuscript theorem to a formal theorem.

Result family	Manuscript proof	Formal status
AME support counting and complete Weyl-basis rigidity	Sections 2–3	coordinate squeeze, unique local labels, and the abstract axis criterion are kernel checked; the concrete additive-state marginal composition is not
Minimum-support transition maps and phase correction	Section 4	minimum-support generation, the abstract holonomy centralizer, and the stabilizer-character algebra are kernel checked; the state-ray correction is a manuscript step; the systematic half-set form, block-minor criterion, optimal direct sum, and finite recognition bounds are manuscript only
Local endomorphism algebra, five prime-field types, and low-party theorem	Section 5 and Appendix A	manuscript only; the existing abstract holonomy-centralizer core does not formalize the intrinsic algebra identification, five-type composition, low-party commutativity, or module consequences
Encoder Clifford no-go	Section 4	the Choi orientation and Clifford closure are kernel checked; the complete arbitrary-additive encoder theorem is assembled in the manuscript
Cleaning, Weyl–Fourier rounding, branch selection, and residual stability	Section 6	manuscript only; neither the leakage constant 8, the Fourier rounding lemma, the balanced-cut estimate, nor the global radius is formalized
Relative exact-base intertwiner reduction	Section 6	exact line transport, defect invariance, product-intertwiner composition, and lossless transfer of a supplied threshold and coefficient are kernel checked; the cleaning inputs remain manuscript proofs
Robust transition compatibility and character obstruction	Section 6	manuscript only
Two- and k -uniform stability and alternative radii	Appendix B	only the generator splitting, single-exponential identity, polarized second-moment identity, and absence of a nonscalar continuous symmetry are kernel checked; all quantitative constants are manuscript only

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